I

DEEP-DIVE DOSSIER

Genesis

The book Dominion quotes first and reads least

Genesis 1.28

Be fruitful and multiply, and fill the earth and subdue it,

and have dominion over the fish of the sea and over the birds of the air and over every living thing that moves upon the earth.

✣

The verse the Dominions are named after (**AM**). Fish, birds and living things. No people.

SOURCE MARGIN

GEN 1–50

MT · LXX

ALTER, GENESIS (TRANS.)

WESTERMANN, GENESIS 1–11

TKC: AM

DEEP-DIVE DOSSIER I · ✣

GENESIS

Everything the Empire claims about men, women, land and order is traced back to fifty chapters that spend most of their length undermining that claim.

WHY THIS ONE IS FIRST

It's the source of the Empire's founding doctrine and of your own earliest religious education. Both need digging out, and this dossier is the model for the three that follow.

HOW TO WORK IT

Reference is about a third of these pages, and the rest is yours. A half-filled dossier is more useful than a blank one.

GEN 1.1

GEN 1–11

GEN 12–50

GEN 50.26

WESTERMANN, GENESIS 1–11

ENUMA ELISH · ATRAHASIS

TKC: TL

WHAT IT IS

NAME	Greek *genesis*, "origin." Hebrew *Bereshit*, "in the beginning." Hebrew books are named for their first words more than their contents.
PLACE	The first book of the Torah in every collection. Nobody disputes its position, and nearly everything else about it is discussed.
AUTHORSHIP	Traditionally Moses. **CONTESTED** Most critical scholars read it as woven from more than one source and period, with major editing in or after the exile, and the two creation accounts are the clearest seam. The classic documentary hypothesis has been heavily revised since the 1970s, and traditional readers hold to a single author.
GENRES INSIDE	Cosmology, genealogy, origin stories, family saga, legal precedent, poetry, dream reports and a novella-length court story in the Joseph chapters. Don't run one test across all fifty chapters.
STRUCTURE	Chapters 1–11, the primeval history, from creation to the scattering of peoples. Chapters 12–50, one family across four generations, ending with Joseph's coffin in Egypt (50.26). The seam shows, and the two halves behave differently.
SETTING	No king, no priesthood and no temple. Everything happens in households, and households decide who inherits.
NEIGHBORS	Mesopotamian creation and flood literature covers similar ground with different theology. Comparison is where Genesis's own claims become visible.

> **WHAT THE BOOK IS ACTUALLY ABOUT, IF IT'S ABOUT ONE THING**
>
> **INTERPRETATION** Blessing that keeps passing to the wrong person. Younger over elder, the barren over the fertile, the deceiver over the dutiful, the foreigner into the family. A book used to justify hierarchy spends fifty chapters disrupting the hierarchy it names most often, birth order.

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHAT I ALREADY THINK THIS BOOK SAYS, BEFORE READING IT AGAIN

GEN 1.1–2.3

GEN 2.4–25

EXOD 18.4

DEUT 33.29

PS 121.1–2

EXOD 26.20

TRIBLE, GOD AND THE RHETORIC OF SEXUALITY

Two accounts, unreconciled

The book opens with two creation accounts in a row, differing in order, method, vocabulary and picture of God. The editors who assembled it kept both. It's the first thing Genesis teaches about how scripture works.

	FIRST ACCOUNT · 1.1–2.3	SECOND ACCOUNT · 2.4B–25
NAME FOR GOD	Elohim, "God"	YHWH Elohim, "the LORD God"
STARTING POINT	Dark water, the deep	Dry ground, no plants, no rain, no one to work it
ORDER	Light, sky, land and plants, lights, sea creatures and birds, land animals, humans last	The human first, then a garden, trees, animals, then the woman
METHOD	Speech and separation	Shaping dust, breathing, planting, building
HUMANS	Male and female together, both in God's image (1.27)	The human (*ha'adam*) from the ground (*ha'adamah*), the woman built from his side
THEIR TASK	Fill the earth, subdue it, have dominion over the creatures (1.28)	Work the garden and keep it (2.15)
ENDS WITH	God resting on the seventh day	Two people naked and unashamed

THE HELPER · 2.18

God makes "a helper fit for him," *'ezer kenegdo*. The noun *'ezer* appears about twenty times in the Hebrew Bible, and most of them describe God helping Israel. It names whoever supplies what the other can't, so "assistant" is a poor gloss. *Kenegdo* means "corresponding to him." The word usually translated "rib," *tsela*, means "side" nearly everywhere else, including the sides of the tabernacle.

WHAT DOMINION DOES WITH THE PAIR

POSSIBLE Teaches the second account as the operative one and the first as poetry. Order of creation becomes order of authority, "helper" becomes a job description, and dominion over the earth quietly becomes dominion inside the household. No word has to change. The only change is which account counts as doctrine.

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHICH ACCOUNT I WAS TAUGHT, AND WHICH ONE I'D NEVER NOTICED WAS SEPARATE

WRITING

GEN 1.26–28

GEN 2.15

VON RAD, GENESIS

TKC: DOM

Work the doctrine

Two doctrines come out of these chapters and both hold weight for the Empire. Write them out in Dominion's voice before you write your objection. The Empire's version has to be truly persuasive or Eden's crisis isn't a crisis.

1 · THE IMAGE OF GOD. WHAT THE EMPIRE SAYS IT MEANS, AND WHO IT QUIETLY LEAVES OUT

2 · DOMINION AS STEWARDSHIP OR AS OWNERSHIP. THE EMPIRE'S ARGUMENT AT ITS BEST

3 · MY OBJECTION, IN ONE PARAGRAPH I'D DEFEND OUT LOUD

4 · WHERE THIS LANDS IN THE MANUSCRIPT: SCENE, CHAPTER OR CATECHISM

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

The primeval history

INTERPRETATION Four movements, each ending worse than it began, and each answered with a promise more than a punishment. The pattern is the argument.

THE GARDEN · 3	The serpent asks a question and the woman answers, adding that they mustn't even touch the tree. She eats and gives fruit to her husband, "who was with her" (3.6). Only two things are cursed, the serpent and the ground. The woman isn't cursed, and neither is the man. Her pain in childbearing and his toil on the land are the same Hebrew noun, *'itstsavon*. The chapter never uses the word "sin," which first appears in 4.7, spoken to Cain. The fruit is never an apple. The apple came from a Latin pun on *malum*, "evil" and "apple."
THE FIRST KILLING · 4	Violence arrives within a generation of the garden, and God answers it with a mark of protection, not an execution. The first city in the book is founded by the murderer. Genesis isn't sentimental about civilization.
THE FLOOD · 6–9	The counting runs two ways at once, pairs of animals and sevens, forty days and a hundred and fifty, which source critics read as two accounts woven together. Mesopotamian flood stories share the structure and differ sharply on why it happens. This one ends with a one-sided promise never to do it again, and the sign is a war bow hung in the clouds.
THE TOWER · 11	One people, one language and a building project so they won't be scattered. They're scattered anyway. **INTERPRETATION** Read beside an empire that standardizes speech and centralizes construction, it's the most politically pointed story in the first eleven chapters, and the one Dominion would find hardest to teach honestly.

"HE SHALL RULE OVER YOU" · 3.16

Prescription or description. Read as prescription, God sets male rule in place. Read as description, the verse names what the break has done to the pair. The word for "desire," *teshuqah*, appears three times in the Hebrew Bible: here, in 4.7 where sin's desire is for Cain, and in Song 7.10, the man's desire for the woman. The Empire has never once presented this as a dispute.

GEN 3
GEN 4.7
GEN 4.8–17
GEN 6–9
GEN 11.1–9
SONG 7.10
1 TIM 2.13–14
GILGAMESH XI · ATRAHASIS

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHICH OF THE FOUR IS DOMINION'S FOUNDING MYTH, AND WHICH IS ITS INDICTMENT

Four generations

One household carrying a promise it keeps putting at risk. Read the right column before writing anything about inheritance in the Empire.

GENERATION	WHAT HAPPENS	HOW THE ORDER BREAKS
ABRAHAM AND SARAH	Called to leave, promised land and children, and childless for decades. Sarah gives Hagar to Abraham, and Hagar bears Ishmael. Hagar flees once and is expelled once. A covenant, a near-sacrifice, and a burial cave that's the only land actually acquired.	The firstborn isn't the heir. The enslaved woman's son gets his own promise.
ISAAC AND REBEKAH	The quietest generation. Rebekah asks God about the struggle in her womb, gets the oracle directly and acts on it.	The younger twin is named before birth, and the mother makes it happen.
JACOB, LEAH AND RACHEL	Deception both ways, two sisters married to one man, four mothers of twelve sons, twenty years of labor and a night of wrestling that leaves him renamed and limping.	The unloved wife bears the priests and the kings. The blessing arrives through a lie and isn't withdrawn.
JOSEPH AND HIS BROTHERS	Sold by his brothers, jailed on a false accusation, raised to run an empire's grain and reunited with a family he can now feed or destroy.	The eleventh son governs. Judah carries the royal line.

THE JOSEPH MATERIAL IS AN ADMINISTRATION STORY

A famine is forecast and grain is centralized. Over the crisis the population sells its money, its livestock, its land and finally itself to the crown for food (47.13–26). The Hebrew says he moved the people into the cities, and the Samaritan and Greek texts say he made them slaves. The priests keep their land. A fifth of every harvest goes to Pharaoh "to this day," and the people thank him. Exodus opens on the consequence.

CONTESTED Whether Genesis presents the policy as wise government or as the start of a trap. The text praises his wisdom and records the cost without comment.

GEN 12–25
GEN 24–27
GEN 29–35
GEN 37–50
GEN 41.34–36
GEN 47.13–26
EXOD 1.8–11
SPEISER, GENESIS (AB)

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHICH DOMINION POLICY IS THE JOSEPH ADMINISTRATION, AND WHO IN THE EMPIRE ADMIRES HIM

Seven promises

The book's spine is a promise made seven times, often to someone with less standing to receive it, each with a different sign. Note what's asked in return. For most of them, almost nothing.

TO WHOM	WHAT'S PROMISED, AND WHAT'S ASKED	THE SIGN
NOAH AND EVERY LIVING CREATURE · 9	No flood will destroy the earth again. Made with all flesh, and nothing is required. The only unconditional promise in the book.	A bow in the clouds
ABRAM AT THE CALL · 12	Land, a great nation, a great name, and blessing for "all the families of the earth." Asked only to leave.	None. Only the going.
ABRAM BETWEEN THE PIECES · 15	Descendants like the stars, the land, and four hundred years of oppression first. A firepot and torch pass between the halves. God alone passes through, and Abram sleeps.	Fire between the pieces
ABRAHAM AND SARAH RENAMED · 17	Many nations, kings, an everlasting covenant, a son by Sarah. Asked: circumcision of every male in the household, slaves included.	Flesh
HAGAR, TWICE IN THE WILDERNESS · 16, 21	Descendants too many to count and a great nation from Ishmael. She's enslaved, foreign and expelled, and the promise is in the patriarch's terms.	A well, and a name for God
JACOB AT BETHEL · 28	The same promise, to a man running from the brother he cheated. Jacob answers with a conditional vow of his own.	A stone, and a stairway
JUDAH, IN THE DEATHBED BLESSING · 49	His brothers will bow and the scepter won't leave him. Spoken by the dying Jacob and not by God. "Until Shiloh comes" is one of the most disputed phrases in the book.	Words only

THE STRUCTURE UNDERNEATH

INTERPRETATION The ceremony in chapter 15 borrows the shape of an ancient treaty between a greater power and a lesser one and inverts the key term, since the greater power walks the path alone. It's a reading, and a well-supported one.

GEN 9.8–17
GEN 12.1–3
GEN 15
GEN 17
GEN 16.10–13
GEN 21.17–18
GEN 28.10–22
GEN 49.8–12
ANE SUZERAIN TREATIES

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHICH PROMISE DOMINION CLAIMS TO STAND ON, AND WHICH TERMS IT LEAVES OUT TO DO IT

WHO INHERITS, AND WHY NOT

In every generation the promise passes over the firstborn. The Empire runs on birth order, and this is the book it says it runs on.

FIRSTBORN	PASSED OVER FOR	WHERE
CAIN	Seth, after Abel's death	4.25
ISHMAEL	Isaac. The displaced son still receives a nation.	21.10–12
ESAU	Jacob, by oracle, appetite and deception. Nobody undoes it afterward.	25.23, 27
REUBEN	Judah for rule, Joseph for the double portion	49.3–4, 8–12, 22–26
MANASSEH	Ephraim, by Jacob's crossed hands	48.13–20
ZERAH	Perez, who breaks out first at birth	38.27–30

WOMEN DECIDE SEVERAL OF THESE

Sarah demands Hagar's expulsion, and God tells Abraham to listen to her (21.12). Rebekah engineers Jacob's blessing and takes the risk on herself, "Upon me be your curse, my son" (27.13). Tamar forces Judah to acknowledge her son. **INTERPRETATION** Genesis treats inheritance as election and never as law. The legal heir is the one person the story reliably doesn't choose.

WHERE THE VANE SUCCESSION SITS ON THIS PAGE, AND WHO IS THE ISHMAEL OF THAT HOUSE

GEN 4.25

GEN 21.10–12

GEN 25.23

GEN 38.27–30

GEN 48.13–20

GEN 49.3–4

1 CHR 5.1–2

RUTH 4.18–22

TKC: TL · MEN

GEN 16

GEN 21

GEN 24–27

GEN 29–30

GEN 34

GEN 38

FRYMER-KENSKY, READING THE WOMEN OF THE BIBLE

WILLIAMS, SISTERS IN THE WILDERNESS

Six women, six levers

CONTENT NOTE The Dinah row concerns sexual violence and a massacre.

Genesis pays unusual attention to women without being kind to them. Each of these six works inside a system that gives her no formal power, and each finds a different lever. The character work comes from this page.

WHO	WHAT SHE DOES, AND WHAT IT COSTS	THE LEVER
HAGAR	Enslaved, given to Abram as a wife, treated harshly with the verb Exodus uses for Egypt. She flees once and is expelled once. She's the only person in scripture who names God, and she does it alone. She later finds Ishmael a wife, head of her own household.	None. She has none, and is met anyway.
SARAH	Barren from her first mention, twice passed off as Abraham's sister to protect him, and the one who demands Hagar's expulsion. She laughs at the promise and denies it. God names the boy "he laughs," and she plays on the name afterward.	Household authority, used against a woman with less.
REBEKAH	Answers "I will go" about her own departure, asks God directly about her pregnancy, and redirects the blessing. Her death is never narrated.	Information, and the willingness to act on it first.
LEAH	Married by deception to a man who wanted her sister, and "hated," the text says. Names her sons as running commentary on her marriage. Mother of Levi and Judah, priests and kings. Buried beside Jacob, where Rachel isn't.	Endurance, and the naming of sons.
DINAH	**CONTESTED** Most readers take chapter 34 as rape, and some read the verb as shaming more than force. Used as the pretext for a massacre by her brothers. She doesn't speak once.	Silence. The text's, not hers.
TAMAR	Denied the marriage owed her, she veils herself, takes Judah's seal, cord and staff as a pledge, and produces them when he orders her burned. "She is more righteous than I."	Documentation. She keeps the receipt.

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHICH OF THE SIX IS EDEN, WHICH IS CELESTE, AND WHICH IS THE ONE NOBODY IN TKC HAS BEEN YET

YOURS

WRITING

PART II, WOMEN OF THE TEXT

One woman, all the way down

Pick one from the facing page and work her fully. Don't pick the one you already have an opinion about.

> **THE PATTERN WORTH TAKING**
>
> **INTERPRETATION** Every one of them works the system more than escaping it, and the two who win outright, Rebekah and Tamar, win with information and evidence.
> **POSSIBLE** Eden's method is on this page. So is Celeste's, who wrote "deceased" on the Empire's authority line and made the form answer to it (**DR3**).

SHE IS, AND HER PASSAGES

WHAT THE TEXT SAYS SHE DOES, AND WHAT IT DECLINES TO SAY ABOUT IT

WHAT SHE'S REDUCED TO IN SERMONS AND STUDY NOTES

WHAT DOMINION WOULD TEACH ABOUT HER TO GIRLS AT DESIGNATION AGE

THE SCENE SHE UNLOCKS, AND WHO IN THE PARISH HOUSEHOLD HAS LIVED IT

☐ **POSSIBLE** ☐ **OPEN QUESTION** ☐ **DECIDED** **LOG NO.** **DATE**

Six fault lines

Sorted by the four kinds of disagreement from the Contested Readings module: I scholarly, II denominational, III open theological, IV unsupported.

THE DISPUTE	KIND	WHAT'S ACTUALLY AT STAKE
THE IMAGE OF GOD	III	Whether it names a capacity, a status, a function or a relationship, and whether it's held individually or only together. The text doesn't define it, and every definition since has been an argument about who qualifies.
"HE SHALL RULE OVER YOU"	I	Prescription or description. The Hebrew permits both, and specialists divide.
THE CURSE OF HAM	IV	The text curses Canaan, not Ham, says nothing about skin, and was attached centuries later to justify racial slavery. A documented misuse more than a contested reading, and the most important thing in this book for TKC to get exactly right.
SODOM	II	What the city is condemned for. The narrative centers a mob's violent demand against guests under protection. Ezekiel names pride, excess and refusing the poor (16.49). Traditions differ.
THE BINDING OF ISAAC	III	A test passed, a test failed, a polemic against child sacrifice, or a horror the text won't soften. Sarah isn't told, and in the narrative Abraham and Sarah never speak again.
GENRE OF CHAPTERS 1–11	II	Historical report, theological narrative, or a kind of writing modern categories don't divide well. The difference drives most modern conflict over the book.

> **THE ONE TO HANDLE WITH BOTH HANDS**
>
> Row three. A category IV claim built into centuries of law and preaching is exactly what Dominion would still teach, and what a novel mustn't reproduce carelessly while depicting it. Write the Empire believing it. Don't let the companion be vague about its falsity.

GEN 1.27

GEN 3.16

GEN 9.20–27

GEN 19

EZEK 16.49

GEN 22

GOLDENBERG, THE CURSE OF HAM

LEVENSON, DEATH AND RESURRECTION OF THE BELOVED SON

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHICH OF THE SIX DOMINION TEACHES AS SETTLED, AND WHO IN THE EMPIRE KNOWS OTHERWISE

Run the eight

One Genesis passage, all eight questions, and two translations side by side. A good first run is the sentence about ruling in 3.16.

PASSAGE

THE TWO RENDERINGS, COPIED OUT WORD FOR WORD

1 · GENRE

2 · SPEAKER

3 · AUDIENCE

4 · BEFORE AND AFTER

5 · WHAT WORLD PRODUCED IT

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

6 · WHAT THE WORDS DO, AND WHERE THE TWO TRANSLATIONS PART

WHO GAINS, WHO PAYS

The last two questions, with room to answer them properly, and the record of what the run produced. Nothing on this spread is canon until the status row is filled.

7 · WHO GAINS FROM EACH READING. NAME THEM, INCLUDING WHERE I BENEFIT

8 · WHAT EACH READING COSTS, AND WHO PAYS IT

DOMINION'S READING	WHERE I CURRENTLY LAND

WHAT STILL NEEDS A REAL SOURCE: LEXICON, COMMENTARY OR MANUSCRIPT NOTE

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

METHOD

BDB · HALOT

TKC: DOM

PART IX LOG

EXOD 1.8–14

EZEK 16.49

RUTH 4.18–22

MATT 1.1–17

ROM 4

ROM 5.12–21

GAL 3

GAL 4.21–31

1 TIM 2.11–15

REV 22.1–5

Who used it next

Genesis is quoted, argued with and rewritten across the rest of the collection. Every later use is somebody deciding what the book meant, which is what Dominion does, with a printing press and a lectionary.

WHO	WHAT THEY DO WITH IT
EXODUS	Opens on the result of Joseph's administration. The descendants of the man who centralized the grain are the forced labor. **INTERPRETATION** The two books are one argument, and almost nobody teaches them that way.
THE PROPHETS	Reach back to Abraham and Sodom as precedent. Ezekiel names Sodom's sin as pride, plenty and refusing the poor, a reading of Genesis printed inside the Bible.
RUTH	Closes by tracing David's line through Perez, Tamar's son. The line has always run through outsiders and irregular unions.
MATTHEW	Opens the New Testament with a Genesis-style genealogy and names Tamar in it, with Rahab, Ruth and "the wife of Uriah."
PAUL	Uses Abraham to argue the promise came before the law, Adam as a pattern for Christ, and Hagar as an allegory (Gal 4). Genesis as precedent for a present fight, the same move Dominion makes, aimed differently.
THE PASTORALS	Cite the order of creation and the deception in the garden as grounds for restricting women's teaching (1 Tim 2.13–14). For TKC, the most consequential later use of Genesis 2–3.
REVELATION	Ends the collection by reversing the opening: a garden inside a city, the tree open again, the serpent finished.

AFTERLIVES, BRIEFLY

Jewish midrash treats the gaps as invitations and argues in the margins for centuries. Christian allegory reads the garden forward into doctrine. The Reformation reads it for law and grace. Modern criticism asks who wrote it and when. Each tradition answers a different question, and none reads it cold.

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHICH LATER USE DOMINION INHERITED WITHOUT KNOWING IT WAS AN INTERPRETATION

GEN 9.20–27

GEN 2–3

1 TIM 2.11–15

GEN 1.28

GEN 3.16

GOLDENBERG, THE CURSE OF HAM

HAYNES, NOAH'S CURSE

WHITE, "HISTORICAL ROOTS" (1967)

Four documented misuses

These aren't contested readings. They're historical uses of the book to justify harm, and a novel about an empire built on scripture has to know them well enough not to reproduce them by accident.

I · THE SO-CALLED CURSE OF HAM	Noah curses Canaan, Ham's son, and not Ham (9.25). Nothing in the passage mentions skin, color or Africa. David Goldenberg's *The Curse of Ham* (2003) traces how later interpreters attached blackness to Ham and slavery to blackness, and shows the supposed derivation of "Ham" from a word for "black" doesn't hold. In the Atlantic world it became a standard justification for enslaving Africans. Stephen Haynes documents its central place in American proslavery argument in *Noah's Curse* (2002).
II · ORDER OF CREATION AS PERMANENT RANK	Made second, so subordinate. Deceived first, so untrustworthy. Built by reading the second account as a hierarchy chart and setting the first aside, and used to bar women from teaching, testifying, holding property and holding office. **INTERPRETATION** Order alone settles rank in neither account, since the animals come before both humans in chapter 1.
III · DOMINION AS LICENSE	A grant over the earth and its creatures turned into a warrant for extraction, conquest and taking inhabited land. The verse concerns creatures and soil and says nothing about authority over other peoples. Lynn White Jr. made the charge famous in 1967, and the stewardship reading is the main answer.
IV · CHILDBEARING AS A SENTENCE	Pain in childbirth read as a penalty women should bear, and used to refuse them relief. When James Young Simpson began using chloroform in labor in 1847, he published an answer to religious objections. **CONTESTED** Historians debate how widespread the clerical opposition really was.

HOW TO WRITE THESE

Let Dominion hold them sincerely and argue them well, which is what makes the Empire frightening more than cartoonish. Don't let the companion be vague about whether they're true. Sincerity and falsity are both required, and they belong on different pages.

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHICH OF THE FOUR IS LAW IN DOMINION, AND WHO TEACHES IT BELIEVING IT

TKC: DOM · AM

GEN 1.26–28

THE SIX INSTRUMENTS, MODULE II

What the Empire took

Four doctrines Dominion draws from this book, each traceable to a verse and each needing the rest of the chapter left out. Fill the right column with the instrument from the six: the calendar, the readings, clergy access, schoolbooks, provincial editions or commentary.

DOCTRINE	WHAT HAS TO BE LEFT OUT FOR IT TO HOLD	INSTRUMENT
Order of the household	The first creation account entirely, and the fact that the ruling sentence sits in a description of loss more than a design specification.	
Fruitfulness as duty	The blessing is given to humanity together, and three of the book's matriarchs are barren for years without being judged for it.	
Dominion itself	The grant covers the earth and its creatures and never other people, and the Empire's name comes from a verse that doesn't authorize it.	
Order restored after collapse	The flood story ends with a promise never to do it again, which makes divine catastrophe a poor template for a state that stages one.	

CORRECTION TO THE OLD COMPANION The old page said "four of the book's central women" were barren. Three are, Sarah (11.30), Rebekah (25.21) and Rachel (29.31). Leah is the fertile one. It also said Hagar was driven out twice. She flees once and is expelled once.

THE NAME PROBLEM

The Dominions are named after a verse about rule over the earth and its creatures (AM). **INFERENCE** The verse is 1.28, or 1.26, the only places in Genesis where humans are told to "have dominion." Somebody in the founding generation chose that word and knew what it said. **OPEN QUESTION** Who named the Dominions, and does the Temple teach the verse as rule or as care?

WHO NAMED THE DOMINIONS, AND WHETHER IT WAS PIETY OR A JOKE

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHO NAMED THE DOMINIONS, AND WHETHER IT WAS PIETY OR A JOKE

YOURS

PART IX LOG

QUEUE: D1

WHAT CHANGED

Close every dossier the same way: what you believed, what you found, what's still open and what's now canon. Nothing on the earlier pages is canon until it's entered here and in the log.

WHAT I BELIEVED ABOUT GENESIS BEFORE THIS DOSSIER

WHAT SURPRISED ME, AND WHY SURPRISE ISN'T EVIDENCE YET

WHAT STAYS OPEN, AND WHAT I NEED A REAL SOURCE FOR

WHAT I'M MAKING CANON FROM THIS BOOK, AND THE LOG NUMBER IT GETS

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

NOTES

OPEN NOTES

ANYTHING THIS DOSSIER STARTED AND DIDN'T FINISH

II

DEEP-DIVE DOSSIER

Exodus

The book every liberation movement has quoted and every empire has learned to quote back

Labor Return, Store Cities of Pithom and Raamses

BRICK QUOTA

FILED BY THE TASKMASTERS · COUNTERSIGNED BY THE FOREMEN OF THE PEOPLE

QUOTA	*the same number of bricks as before*
STRAW	*no longer supplied. Gather your own.*
SHORTFALL	*the foremen are beaten*
COMPLAINT LODGED	*"You are idle, you are idle" (5.17)*
BIRTHS REPORTED	*boys to the river · 1.22*

Exodus 5 is a labor dispute in writing, quotas and all. The book's God is introduced as someone who heard the complaint (3.7).

QUOTA UNMET

SOURCE MARGIN

EXOD 1–40

MT · LXX

PROPP, EXODUS (AB)

CHILDS, EXODUS (OTL)

MEYERS, EXODUS (NCBC)

DEEP-DIVE DOSSIER II · ✣

EXODUS

It doesn't end at the sea. Two thirds of the book is what happens after the escape: law, labor, ritual and a people arguing with the God who brought them out.

WHY A FULL DOSSIER

Dominion's whole deliverance liturgy is built on this book, and so is every argument against it. The audit assigns a full dossier and warns against stopping at the escape. This one doesn't.

HOW TO WORK IT

Reference is about a third of these pages, and the rest is yours. Content notes come before pages 6 and 11.

EXOD 1.1

EXOD 1–15

EXOD 19–24

EXOD 25–40

PROPP, EXODUS 1–18

LAWS OF HAMMURABI (ROTH)

TKC: DOM

What it is

NAME	Greek *exodos*, "a going out." Hebrew *Shemot*, "names," from the opening list of those who came down to Egypt. The Greek title names the event and the Hebrew title names the people.
PLACE	The hinge of the Torah. A family becomes a people, and the people becomes a nation with law. Genesis ends with a household in Egypt, and Exodus opens with a labor force.
AUTHORSHIP	Traditionally Moses. **CONTESTED** Modern scholarship generally sees more than one hand and a lot of editing, with the law collections and the tabernacle chapters treated as separate bodies of text.
HISTORICITY	There's no outside record of the departure as the book describes it, and proposals for its date, scale and route vary widely. This dossier treats the narrative as scripture and literature and prints no reconstruction as history.
STRUCTURE	Chapters 1–15, oppression and departure. 16–18, the wilderness and the first administration. 19–24, Sinai, the ten words and the covenant code. 25–40, the sanctuary plans, broken by the calf. The escape is a third of the book.
GENRES INSIDE	Narrative, genealogy, the plague cycle, victory poetry, case law, absolute command, ritual calendar and construction specification. The tabernacle chapters are an architectural document. Don't read them the way you read chapter 14.
NEIGHBORS	Ancient Near Eastern law collections, Hammurabi's among them, cover much of the same legal ground in the same "if this, then that" form. Reading the covenant code beside them shows what's conventional in it and what isn't.

> **WHAT THE BOOK IS ACTUALLY ABOUT**
>
> **INTERPRETATION** Who owns a people's labor, and what a people owes the one who freed them. The question doesn't close when they leave Egypt. It becomes the law, then the argument, then the sanctuary.

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHAT I ALREADY THINK THIS BOOK SAYS, BEFORE READING IT AGAIN

EXOD 1.8–22

EXOD 2.1–10

EXOD 2.16–22

EXOD 4.24–26

EXOD 6.20

NUM 26.59

MEYERS, EXODUS

TKC: MIRIAM

Six women, then Moses

Before the deliverer says a word, women have already beaten the policy. Two midwives refuse an execution order and lie to the king about it, a mother hides a child, a sister watches over the rescue, and a princess of the ruling house adopts him and pays his mother to nurse him.

WHO	WHAT THE TEXT ACTUALLY SAYS
SHIPHRAH AND PUAH	Ordered to kill Hebrew boys at birth, they "feared God" and didn't. Summoned, they answer with a claim the king can't check: Hebrew women give birth before the midwife arrives. God gives them households. They're named and the king isn't. **CONTESTED** "Hebrew midwives" can also be read "midwives to the Hebrews," which would make them Egyptian, and the Greek reads it that way.
THE MOTHER	Hides the child three months, then builds a sealed basket and sets it in the reeds, a plan more than an abandonment. Named only later, as Jochebed (6.20).
THE SISTER	Watches from a distance and offers Pharaoh's daughter a Hebrew nurse at the moment of discovery. **INFERENCE** She's Miriam. Chapter 2 doesn't name her, and Miriam is first named in 15.20.
PHARAOH'S DAUGHTER	Sees the child crying, pities him, knowingly keeps a Hebrew boy alive against her father's decree and names him. She breaks the ruling house's law without opposing it in public.
ZIPPORAH	A Midianite priest's daughter, one of seven sisters Moses defends at a well. She later performs a circumcision at night that saves his life, in a scene nobody explains. The deliverer's family is foreign.
THE OPPRESSION	Forced labor, then harsher labor, then a birth policy. The king's stated fear is numbers: "too many and too mighty" (1.9). Registration logic before any register exists.

THE READING THE PULPIT SKIPS

INTERPRETATION Two of these women are professionals who lie to the state, and the text approves. Two are mothers running an operation across a class line. One is a daughter of the regime. Any account of Exodus that starts with a burning bush has skipped the part where ordinary women had already made the deliverer possible.

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHO IN MY CAST IS SHIPHRAH, INSIDE THE SYSTEM AND QUIETLY NOT COMPLYING

WRITING

EXOD 1

TKC: DOM · TR

Build the refusal

Exodus 1 gives a working model of resistance that doesn't look like resistance: people with licensed access refusing to do the one thing the license exists for. Draft Dominion's version here. This page is source material for the Trials.

1 · WHICH LICENSED PROFESSION IN DOMINION COULD REFUSE AN ORDER AND SURVIVE IT

2 · THE ANSWER THEY GIVE WHEN SUMMONED. WRITE IT AS DIALOGUE

3 · A WOMAN OF THE RULING HOUSE WHO BREAKS ITS LAW WITHOUT OPPOSING IT IN PUBLIC

4 · THE POLICY THAT FOLLOWS WHEN QUIET REFUSAL IS DISCOVERED. WHAT ESCALATES

A NAME THAT WON'T SETTLE

Moses asks for a name to carry back as credentials and gets a first-person verb, then a four-letter name, then a promise about ancestors. The whole scene turns on what authority a sent person can produce.

THE SCENE	A bush that burns without burning up, on a mountain, while Moses is working his father-in-law's flock in a foreign country. The call reaches him at work, in exile, doing a job that belongs to his wife's family.
WHAT GOD SAYS FIRST	A report of having heard. "I have seen the affliction of my people… I have heard their cry because of their taskmasters" (3.7). The stated reason for acting is the noise the oppressed make.
THE PHRASE IN 3.14	*'ehyeh 'asher 'ehyeh*. "I am who I am" is the familiar rendering. The verb form can also mean "I will be what I will be," so the tense is genuinely open, and the tense you choose changes the theology.
THE FOUR LETTERS · 3.15	YHWH. Jewish readers traditionally don't pronounce it and say *Adonai*, "my Lord," or *HaShem*, "the Name." Most English Bibles print LORD in small capitals. "Jehovah" is a hybrid of the consonants with Adonai's vowels, and "Yahweh" is a scholarly reconstruction. This companion doesn't print a pronunciation. **CONTESTED** 6.3 says the ancestors didn't know this name, though Genesis uses it throughout.
FIVE OBJECTIONS	Who am I. What's your name. They won't believe me. I'm "heavy of mouth." Please send someone else. Only the last makes God angry, and the answer is Aaron.
THE NIGHT SCENE · 4.24–26	"The LORD met him and sought to put him to death." Zipporah cuts her son's foreskin with a flint, touches it to "his feet" and says "Surely you are a bridegroom of blood to me." The text doesn't say whom God was attacking, whose feet, why, or what the words mean. Every clear translation has supplied the answers. It stays unsmoothed here.

WHY A NAME IS WHAT HE ASKS FOR

INTERPRETATION In a world of named local gods, a name is jurisdiction. It tells you whose authority you're invoking and where it applies. Moses is asking what to say when the elders ask who sent him. Dominion understands this, which is why the Sanctum controls the forms of address.

EXOD 3.1–15

EXOD 4.1–17

EXOD 4.24–26

EXOD 6.2–3

BDB · HALOT

CHILDS, EXODUS

PROPP, EXODUS 1–18

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHAT NAME I WAS TAUGHT FOR GOD, AND WHO TAUGHT ME NOT TO USE ANOTHER

Who is allowed to say it

WRITING

EXOD 3–4

TKC: DOM · SANCTUM

Dominion governs address: which name, which title, in whose presence, on whose authority. Exodus 3 is the founding text for that whole apparatus and for its failure, since the name is given to a fugitive shepherd and not to an institution.

1 · THE SANCTUM'S AUTHORIZED FORMS OF ADDRESS, AND WHAT'S FORBIDDEN OUTSIDE THE TEMPLE

2 · A CHARACTER WHO PRAYS USING A NAME THEY WEREN'T GIVEN PERMISSION TO USE

3 · FIVE OBJECTIONS. WRITE THE REFUSALS OF SOMEONE BEING SENT, AND WHAT ANSWERS EACH

4 · A SCENE THAT'S NEVER EXPLAINED. WRITE ONE AND LEAVE IT UNEXPLAINED

EXOD 7–12

EXOD 7.3

EXOD 8.15, 32

EXOD 8.19

EXOD 9.20–21

EXOD 10.7

EXOD 12.12

FRETHEIM, EXODUS

CONTENT NOTE Mass death, including the death of children, presented in the text as divine action. This page doesn't dwell on it. You can work it later, or not at all, and the dossier still functions.

A CONTEST, NOT A TANTRUM

The signs are staged as a public contest over who governs: the Nile, the livestock, the light, the firstborn, each a pillar of Egyptian order and of Pharaoh's claim to guarantee it. God calls the last plague judgment "on all the gods of Egypt" (12.12). **INTERPRETATION** Reading the cycle as an attack on a state's legitimacy, more than a list of disasters, is a strong common reading. The book doesn't state it outright.

SIGN	WHAT IT STRIKES	WHO HARDENS
BLOOD · 7	The Nile, the water supply and the state's central image of life. The court magicians match it.	Pharaoh's heart "was hardened"
FROGS, GNATS, FLIES · 8	Habitability. The magicians fail at the gnats and tell the king, "This is the finger of God" (8.19).	He hardens his own heart
LIVESTOCK, BOILS · 9	Wealth first, then the bodies of the people who run it	God hardens him, from the sixth on
HAIL · 9	The harvest, with a warning first. Some officials heed it and bring their workers and animals inside.	He admits fault, then reverses
LOCUSTS, DARKNESS · 10	Food and daylight. His own courtiers beg him to give in.	The LORD hardens him
THE FIRSTBORN · 11–12	Succession itself, "from the firstborn of Pharaoh who sits on his throne to the firstborn of the slave girl behind the handmill." A great cry in Egypt.	Release, then pursuit

THE HARDENING PROBLEM

Three patterns run through the book. God announces he'll harden Pharaoh's heart (4.21, 7.3), Pharaoh hardens it himself (8.15, 8.32, 9.34), and sometimes it simply "was hardened." Three Hebrew verbs share the work, to strengthen, to make heavy and to make hard, and translations flatten them into one. Whether it's one theology, two sources or a deliberate escalation is argued and not settled here.

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHO PAYS FOR A RULER'S REFUSAL IN DOMINION, AND WHO IS TOLD IT WAS NECESSARY

EXOD 12.1–28

EXOD 12.26–27

EXOD 12.35–36

EXOD 12.38, 48–49

EXOD 13.1–16

PHILO, LIFE OF MOSES 1.141

B. SANHEDRIN 91A

TKC: CELESTE

Passover and memory

The narrative stops at its most urgent point to install a liturgy, with a calendar, a household unit, rules for a household too small for a whole lamb, dress instructions and a script for answering a child's question years later. Liberation is legislated as an annual practice before it has happened.

THE HOUSEHOLD IS THE UNIT	No temple, no city and no priesthood yet. Aaron and his sons aren't ordained until Leviticus 8. A family, a doorway and a shared meal. The founding rite of the people is performed at home, by whoever's at home.
THE CHILD'S QUESTION	"What do you mean by this service?" (12.26). The answer is a story told in the first person, this is what was done for us. INTERPRETATION Memory passed on as testimony inside a family is exactly what an empire can't license.
WHO ELSE LEFT	A "mixed multitude" goes up with them (12.38), and a circumcised resident foreigner may keep the Passover under "one law" for native and stranger (12.48–49). The founding rite has an inclusion clause and a boundary in the same paragraph.
THE UNPAID WAGES	Israel "asks" the Egyptians for silver, gold and clothing and so "plunders" them. The King James "borrow" made it read like a trick. CONTESTED Philo and a Talmudic story took the goods as back wages for generations of unpaid labor. Others read a parting gift, and others take the plunder language at face value. Name the reading you're using.
THE FIRSTBORN CLAUSE	Right after the deliverance every firstborn male belongs to God and has to be redeemed (13.1–2, 11–16). God had already called Israel "my firstborn son" (4.22). A claim on the next generation is written into the liberation itself.

THE RITE MY FAMILY KEEPS THAT NO INSTITUTION ISSUED, AND WHAT IT PASSES ON

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

THE RITE MY FAMILY KEEPS THAT NO INSTITUTION ISSUED, AND WHAT IT PASSES ON

EXOD 13.17–14.31

EXOD 15.1–18

EXOD 15.20–21

4Q365

MIC 6.4

NUM 12 (COMPARE)

TRIBLE, "BRINGING MIRIAM OUT"

CROSS & FREEDMAN (1955)

Two tellings of one crossing

Chapter 14 tells the crossing in prose, and chapter 15 sings it. They don't describe the mechanics the same way. Reading them together is a lesson in how an event becomes a liturgy and the liturgy becomes the memory.

	THE PROSE · CH. 14	THE SONG · 15.1–18
HOW THE WATER MOVES	A strong east wind all night drives the sea back	"At the blast of your nostrils the waters piled up"
THE EGYPTIANS	Chariot wheels clog, the army turns to run, the water returns at morning	Horse and rider thrown into the sea, sinking like a stone
ISRAEL	Walks through on dry ground, walls of water on both sides	Barely appears. The song is about God.
POINT OF VIEW	The narrator's	The enemy speaks in the first person (15.9)
HOW FAR IT LOOKS	Ends on the shore, with Israel believing	Ahead to Philistia, Edom, Moab and Canaan trembling, and to the sanctuary on God's mountain

MIRIAM, PROPHET AND SONG LEADER

She's called "the prophet" (15.20), the first woman in the Torah given the title. She leads the women with a hand drum and dancing, and her two lines match the song's opening. Micah names her with Moses and Aaron as the three God sent (Mic 6.4). **CONTESTED** Cross and Freedman argued in 1955 that the song was once credited to her, feminist scholars developed the case, and one Qumran manuscript (4Q365) adds lines of a song for Miriam after 15.21. It's a proposal and not a result. Hold this page next to Numbers 12 in focused study F1, where the same woman is punished for speaking.

THE VICTORY SONG DOMINION SINGS, AND WHO IS ALLOWED TO LEAD IT

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

THE VICTORY SONG DOMINION SINGS, AND WHO IS ALLOWED TO LEAD IT

WRITING

EXOD 15.22–27

EXOD 16

EXOD 18.13–26

TKC: DOM

The week after the sea

Three days after the song there's no water, and by chapter 16 they're saying they ate their fill of bread in Egypt. Manna comes with a rule that nobody can hoard it. Jethro, a Midianite priest, watches Moses judge alone from morning to evening and tells him to appoint officers over thousands, hundreds, fifties and tens. Freedom arrives with a supply problem, an administration problem and a memory problem, and most liberation stories leave that part out.

1 · THE FIRST SHORTAGE AFTER A LIBERATION IN MY WORLD, AND WHO'S BLAMED FOR IT

2 · A CHARACTER WHO SAYS OUT LOUD THAT THE OLD ARRANGEMENT FED THEM BETTER

3 · THE MANNA RULE, A RATION NOBODY CAN HOARD. WHAT WOULD DOMINION DO TO IT?

4 · JETHRO'S ADVICE. WRITE THE MOMENT A MOVEMENT GETS A BUREAUCRACY

A TREATY, A MOUNTAIN, A BOUNDARY

EXOD 19

EXOD 20.1–17

DEUT 5 (COMPARE)

EXOD 20.18–21

EXOD 23.12

EXOD 24.3–8

EXOD 34.28

MENDENHALL (1954–55)

INTERPRETATION George Mendenhall compared the Sinai covenant to Hittite treaties between an overlord and a vassal: a preamble, a history of what the overlord has done, stipulations, provisions for reading the text, witnesses, and blessings and curses. The scene also installs access control, a boundary at the foot of the mountain and rules about who may cross it.

THE PREAMBLE IS THE ARGUMENT	"I am the LORD your God, who brought you out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of slavery" (20.2). Obligation rests on a completed act of liberation, and not on creation or raw power. **INTERPRETATION** Any use of the Ten that drops that clause has changed what kind of document it is.
WHO THE SABBATH ADDRESSES	The household head, the son and daughter, the male and female slave, the livestock and the resident foreigner. It's a labor law addressed to the person with the power to compel work. Exodus 23.12 adds a second reason, "that the son of your female slave and the foreigner may be refreshed."
THE LAST COMMAND LISTS PROPERTY	House first, then wife, male and female slaves, ox and donkey (20.17). The wife appears inside an inventory of what a man owns. Deuteronomy puts her first and gives her a separate verb (5.21).
THE PEOPLE ASK FOR A MEDIATOR	Frightened by the thunder, they ask Moses to speak to God for them, "lest we die." The office of the go-between is created by popular request, and every priesthood afterward has that verse available.
RATIFICATION	The covenant is read aloud, the people answer "All that the LORD has spoken we will do," and Moses throws blood on the altar and on the people (24.3–8).

TRADITION	THE FIRST WORD	COVETING
JEWISH	"I am the LORD your God who brought you out"	One commandment
CATHOLIC AND LUTHERAN	No other gods, with images inside it	Split in two
REFORMED, ORTHODOX, ANGLICAN	No other gods, with images second	One commandment

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

DOMINION'S FOUNDING DOCUMENT. WHAT DOES ITS PREAMBLE CLAIM TO HAVE DONE FOR YOU?

CONTENT NOTE Slavery, debt bondage and the legal status of enslaved women and children in the covenant code. The page reports what the text legislates without endorsing it.

The first laws after the ten

Chapters 21–23 are case law in the ordinary ancient form. What's striking is the order. Right after the covenant is ratified, the first subject legislated is slavery, by a people just freed.

DEBT SLAVERY	A Hebrew man bought serves six years and goes free in the seventh. If he came married, his wife leaves with him. If the master gave him a wife, she and the children stay. If he chooses to stay with them, his ear is pierced at the door and he serves for life. Freedom is granted to him and withheld from her.
THE DAUGHTER SOLD	She "shall not go out as the male slaves do." She can't be sold to foreigners, and if the man takes another wife he can't reduce her food, clothing or her third due, *ʿonah*, whose meaning is disputed. If he does, she goes free. The protections are real, and it's still a sale.
INJURY AND STATUS	Kidnapping a person to sell is a capital crime. A master who beats a slave to death is punished, and if the slave survives a day or two there's no penalty, "for he is his money." A slave who loses an eye or a tooth goes free. An ox that kills a slave costs thirty shekels, paid to the master.
MONEY LAW	A poor man's cloak taken in pledge goes back by sunset, "for that is his only covering." Credit is regulated at the point where it takes someone's bedding.
THE FOREIGNER AND THE COURTS	Don't oppress the foreigner, "for you know the heart of a foreigner." Don't favor the poor man in his lawsuit, and don't deny justice to the poor. Impartiality in both directions.

HOW TO READ IT WITHOUT LYING IN EITHER DIRECTION

INTERPRETATION The code doesn't abolish slavery. It isn't a charter for the plantation either, since it limits Hebrew debt servitude, makes kidnapping a capital crime and frees a slave for a lost tooth, and American slave codes did none of that. And it gives women fewer exits than men. Say all three. Permanent slavery of foreigners is authorized elsewhere (Lev 25.44–46), and proslavery writers cited it.

EXOD 21.1–11

EXOD 21.16–32

EXOD 22.21–27

EXOD 23.1–12

LEV 25.44–46

LAWS OF HAMMURABI (ROTH)

WRIGHT, INVENTING GOD'S LAW

TKC: DOM · MEN

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHICH OF THESE CLAUSES DOMINION KEEPS, AND WHICH IT HAS QUIETLY REPEALED

CONTENT NOTE A massacre inside the camp, 32.25–29.

Forty days unsupervised

While the sanctuary plans are being given on the mountain, the people ask the acting authority for gods they can see. Aaron makes a calf out of their gold earrings and announces "a feast to the LORD." The crisis is a leadership vacuum, an authorized official improvising, and a rite in the right name with the wrong object.

AARON ISN'T PUNISHED	He collects the gold, makes the image, builds the altar, announces the feast, and tells Moses he threw the gold in the fire "and out came this calf." He remains high priest. Deuteronomy later says God was angry enough to destroy him and Moses prayed for him (Deut 9.20). Hold that next to who does die in the same chapter.
THE PURGE	Moses calls for whoever is on the LORD's side, the Levites answer, and they go through the camp with swords. About three thousand die, and Moses tells them "today you have been ordained for the LORD," each at the cost of a son or brother. A priesthood is ordained by an internal massacre, and the book says so plainly.
MOSES ARGUES WITH GOD, TWICE	First he talks God out of destroying the people, using what the Egyptians will say and the promise to Abraham, and "the LORD relented." Next he offers to be blotted out of God's book with them. Intercession here is legal advocacy, and God is persuadable.
THE REQUEST TO SEE	He's refused the face and shown the back from a cleft in the rock. What he gets instead is a spoken self-description, "merciful and gracious, slow to anger," forgiving, and by no means clearing the guilty (34.6–7), which later books quote and argue with.
THE SECOND TABLETS	The covenant is rewritten after being broken, and the sanctuary is built from offerings so generous the people have to be told to stop. The book ends with a structure, a cloud and a schedule.

EXOD 32.1–6

EXOD 32.11–14

EXOD 32.21–29

EXOD 32.31–32

EXOD 33.18–23

EXOD 34.6–7

EXOD 36.5–7

DEUT 9.20

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHO IN MY WORLD SURVIVES THE THING THEY BUILT, AND WHO DIES FOR ATTENDING IT

One passage, worked properly

Choose one passage and run the method across this spread. If you want one chosen, try 21.2–11, the slave laws, or 1.15–21, the midwives.

PASSAGE

TRANSLATION USED

1 · WHAT IT SAYS. SUMMARIZE WITHOUT INTERPRETING. NO CONCLUSIONS YET

2 · WHO IS SPEAKING, TO WHOM, IN WHAT SITUATION

3 · WHERE TWO TRANSLATIONS DIFFER, AND WHAT TURNS ON THE DIFFERENCE

METHOD

TKC: DOM

PART IX LOG

How it's been used

4 · HOW THIS PASSAGE HAS BEEN USED AGAINST SOMEONE. NAME THE USE AND NOT ONLY THE ABUSE

5 · WHAT IT REFUSES TO SETTLE. THE QUESTION THE TEXT LEAVES OPEN

6 · WHAT DOMINION WOULD DO WITH IT, AND WHICH CLAUSE THE SANCTUM CIRCULATES

7 · WHAT I'M TAKING INTO THE MANUSCRIPT, AND WHICH CHAPTER

Anything found on these two pages begins as POSSIBLE. Move it to DECIDED only after deciding it belongs in the manuscript and logging where it affects the existing files.

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

The most borrowed book

Exodus is quoted by the enslaved and the enslavers, by prophets, empires, movements and settlers. For a novelist writing an empire with a scripture, the reception history is primary material.

INSIDE THE BIBLE	The prophets judge Israel by the deliverance, the return from exile is told in exodus language, the gospels put Jesus in a wilderness and on a mountain, and Paul reads the crossing as a figure (1 Cor 10). Reuse starts inside the canon.
THE SPIRITUALS	Enslaved Black Americans made Exodus the center of a sung theology, Pharaoh, the river, the promised land, often with a double meaning, a coded present inside a biblical past. "Go Down, Moses" was among the first spirituals published, in 1861, and Harriet Tubman was called Moses. For this companion, the most important reception stream.
SLAVEHOLDER USE	The same book was preached to the enslaved with the deliverance removed and the obedience kept, and the covenant code and Leviticus 25 were cited to show scripture regulates slavery and so allows it. The text didn't prevent this. The selection did it.
THE FOUNDERS	In 1776 Benjamin Franklin proposed a Great Seal showing Pharaoh drowning, under the motto "Rebellion to tyrants is obedience to God."
LIBERATION THEOLOGY	James Cone made the God of the exodus the center of *A Black Theology of Liberation* (1970) and *God of the Oppressed* (1975). God is disclosed as one who takes sides.
THE CANAANITE PROBLEM	Robert Allen Warrior read the story from the Canaanites' side in 1989. The exodus ends in someone else's land, and for Native Americans the Puritans had played Israel. A companion that celebrates the exodus without naming this hasn't finished reading.
THE CIVIL RIGHTS ERA	Movement preaching ran on Pharaoh, the wilderness and the mountaintop. Martin Luther King Jr.'s last sermon, in Memphis on April 3, 1968, ended with Moses' view of the promised land: "I may not get there with you."

ISA 43.16–21

1 COR 10.1–5

RABOTEAU, SLAVE RELIGION (1978)

CONE, A BLACK THEOLOGY OF LIBERATION (1970)

WARRIOR, "CANAANITES, COWBOYS, AND INDIANS" (1989)

TKC: DOM · TL

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHICH RECEPTION STREAM MY CHARACTERS WERE RAISED INSIDE, AND WHO EDITED IT FOR THEM

A DELIVERANCE ALREADY SPENT

EXOD 20.2

EXOD 20.8–11

EXOD 22.25–27

TKC: DOM · SANCTUM

FR 33

POSSIBLE An empire can't suppress this book, because it's too well known. So it dates it. The deliverance is taught as accomplished, in the founding, by the Empire itself, and what's left for the present is the obedience section. Everything below is a TKC construction to test against the manuscript.

WHAT THE SANCTUM CIRCULATES	WHAT IT KEEPS IN THE CLOSED CATECHISM
THE SEA. DELIVERANCE AS A FOUNDING EVENT, ALREADY GRANTED.	Chapter 1. The resistance began with two working women who lied to a king and were rewarded.
THE COMMANDMENTS, FROM THE SECOND CLAUSE ON.	The preamble. The authority to command rests on having ended somebody's forced labor.
SABBATH AS HOUSEHOLD ORDER AND PUBLIC OBSERVANCE.	Sabbath as a limit on what an owner may take from a worker, an animal or a foreigner.
THE TABERNACLE CHAPTERS. COSTLY, ORDERED, BEAUTIFUL WORSHIP.	The seventh-year release, the interest ban and the returned cloak.
MOSES THE LAWGIVER, OBEDIENT AND UNQUESTIONING.	Moses arguing God out of a decision, twice, and offering to be struck from the book.

THE SANCTUM'S PROBLEM WITH THIS BOOK

POSSIBLE A scripture whose God is introduced as having heard a labor complaint can't be fully tamed. Someone in the Temple has to manage that. Whether it sits with the Prelate's office is open. The Prelate's working name is Aurelia (POSSIBLE, FR 33).

CORRECTION TO THE OLD COMPANION SUPERSEDED The old companion marked "Prelate Huldah's office" as canon and gave it the Empire's handling of Exodus. FR 33 renamed the Prelate, and the office's role here is only POSSIBLE now.

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

THE EMPIRE'S DELIVERANCE LITURGY. WRITE THE PART A CHARACTER STOPS BELIEVING

What I take out of Exodus

WRITING

DOSSIER CLOSE

QUEUE: D2

THE ONE THING THIS BOOK CHANGED ABOUT HOW I SEE DOMINION

WHAT I STILL DON'T UNDERSTAND. CARRY IT TO THE RESEARCH LIST.

A LINE, AN IMAGE OR A LAW I'M TAKING STRAIGHT INTO THE MANUSCRIPT

PROOFING GATE *log only, nothing is closed here*

Dossier II has seventeen numbered pages, with content notes on pages 6, 11 and 12. Still outstanding for proofing: full citations with edition and year for the margin entries.

PROOFED BY | DATE | OUTSTANDING

NOTES

OPEN NOTES

ANYTHING THIS DOSSIER STARTED AND DIDN'T FINISH

III

DEEP-DIVE DOSSIER

Leviticus

The book quoted to condemn and never quoted to release

SOURCE MARGIN

LEV 1–27

MT · LXX

MILGROM, LEVITICUS (AB, 3 VOLS.)

KLAWANS, IMPURITY AND SIN IN ANCIENT JUDAISM

Leviticus 25.10, as cast on the Pennsylvania State House bell, 1753

Proclaim LIBERTY Throughout all the Land unto all the Inhabitants Thereof

✣

Lev. XXV. v X. The abolitionists named it the Liberty Bell in the 1830s.

DEEP-DIVE DOSSIER III · ✣

LEVITICUS

Its most famous verses are three. Its longest arguments are about debt, land, wages and the edge of the harvest, and an empire that cites it has to keep those chapters out of general circulation.

WHY A FULL DOSSIER

The audit gives it a dossier on two grounds: the body treated as a jurisdiction, and the economic and restorative demands Dominion suppresses. Both are here, at the length they need.

HOW TO WORK IT

Reference is about a third of these pages, and the rest is yours. Four pages carry content notes. Skip them if you need to, and the dossier still works.

What it is

NAME	English from the Greek and Latin, "about the Levites," though Levites as a group appear only once (25.32–33). Hebrew *Vayikra*, "and he called," the opening word. The Hebrew title names an address, and the Greek names a professional class.
PLACE	Third book of the Torah, set entirely at Sinai. The tabernacle has just been built at the end of Exodus, and Leviticus is what's said from inside it.
AUTHORSHIP	Traditionally Moses. CONTESTED Modern scholarship generally treats chapters 1–16 and 17–26 as separate bodies of priestly material, the second called the Holiness Code since August Klostermann named it in 1877. Dates and order are debated.
STRUCTURE	1–7, offerings. 8–10, the ordination of the priests and its first disaster. 11–15, clean and unclean. 16, the Day of Atonement. 17–26, holiness, sexuality, festivals, land, debt and release. 27, vows and valuations.
GENRE	Ritual instruction, addressed mostly to priests and sometimes to everyone. It's a procedures manual. Read it the way you'd read a professional standard.
A WARNING	More people quote this book than have read it. INTERPRETATION Any argument built from Leviticus that can't say what chapter 25 requires is quoting selectively.

LEV 1.1

LEV 1–16

LEV 17–26

LEV 27

LEV 25.32–33

MILGROM, LEVITICUS 1–16

TKC: DOM

WHAT THE BOOK IS ACTUALLY ABOUT

INTERPRETATION Proximity. What it costs to live near a holy thing, who's admitted, who's put outside and for how long, and what has to be given back before anyone can come near again. Holiness here is a spatial and economic arrangement.

WHAT I WAS TAUGHT LEVITICUS WAS FOR, AND WHICH VERSES I WAS TAUGHT FROM IT

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHAT I WAS TAUGHT LEVITICUS WAS FOR, AND WHICH VERSES I WAS TAUGHT FROM IT

A SYSTEM WITH A SLIDING SCALE

LEV 1–3

LEV 4.1–5.13

LEV 5.14–6.7

MILGROM, LEVITICUS 1–16

TKC: DOM · SANCTUM

Five main offerings, each with its own occasion, procedure and disposal of the parts. Two are for wrongdoing and three aren't. The scale matters. The same rite can be a bull, a bird or a measure of flour, depending on what the worshipper has. Access is priced to income, and the text says so.

OFFERING	WHAT IT IS FOR	BUILT-IN SCALE
BURNT · *ʿOLAH*	The whole animal burned, the standing offering of the sanctuary	A bull, a sheep or goat, or birds
GRAIN · *MINḤAH*	Flour, oil and frankincense. A handful is burned and the rest goes to the priests, with salt, "the salt of the covenant" (2.13).	Cooked or raw, in several forms
WELL-BEING · *SHELAMIM*	A shared meal. The fat is burned, and the worshipper's household eats the meat.	Herd or flock
PURIFICATION · *ḤATTAʾT*, TRADITIONALLY "SIN OFFERING"	Its blood purges the sanctuary of the impurity a person's error or condition has caused	Graded by status, down to two birds, and down to a tenth of an ephah of flour for someone who can't afford birds
REPARATION · *ʾASHAM*, TRADITIONALLY "GUILT OFFERING"	For misusing holy things and defrauding a neighbor under oath	The full amount restored to the wronged person, plus a fifth, before the ram is offered

THE PART NO EMPIRE PREACHES

INTERPRETATION In the reparation law, ritual doesn't stand in for repayment. You can't settle a defrauded neighbor at the altar. The neighbor is paid first, with a penalty added, and only then is the offering brought. A religion that offers forgiveness without restitution has reversed this chapter.

WHAT DOMINION CHARGES FOR ABSOLUTION, AND WHO IS PAID, IF ANYONE

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHAT DOMINION CHARGES FOR ABSOLUTION, AND WHO IS PAID, IF ANYONE

CONTENT NOTE Disease, bodily discharge and exclusion from the community, including quarantine applied to people.

The body as jurisdiction

Impurity in Leviticus is a status, and mostly not a moral one. It limits access to the sanctuary, it's picked up through ordinary events, birth, discharge, illness, contact with a corpse, and it ends with time, washing and sometimes an offering. Translating it as "dirty" or "shameful" brings in a judgment the system doesn't make.

WHAT IT REGULATES	Who may approach, when and after what interval. Almost everyone is impure at some point, priests included, and priests live under stricter rules about corpses. It's a calendar of access more than a register of character.
TWO KINDS	Jonathan Klawans distinguishes ritual impurity, unavoidable and not sinful, from moral impurity, which comes from grave sins like sexual transgression, idolatry and bloodshed, defiles the land and can't be washed off. The later Christian split into moral and ceremonial law maps onto neither neatly.
THE SKIN CHAPTERS · 13–14	*Tsara'at* can appear on skin, on cloth and on the walls of houses. It isn't leprosy in the modern sense, though the Greek *lepra* carried that name into English. A priest inspects, isolates for seven days, inspects again and declares. Someone declared unclean tears their clothes, leaves their hair loose, covers their upper lip, calls out "Unclean, unclean" and lives alone outside the camp. Readmission is as detailed as exclusion.
DIETARY LAW · 11	Animals sorted by stated criteria, split hooves and chewing the cud, fins and scales, never explained. Hygiene, separation from neighbors and Mary Douglas's anomaly reading have all been proposed. None is settled, and the only reason given is holiness.

WHERE THE DANGER IS FOR A WRITER

INTERPRETATION A status system with an inspector, an interval and a public declaration is the most transferable machinery in the Torah. Dominion doesn't need to invent contamination law. It only has to attach moral weight to a status this book keeps mostly non-moral.

LEV 11

LEV 13–14

LEV 13.45–46

DOUGLAS, PURITY AND DANGER (1966)

DOUGLAS, LEVITICUS AS LITERATURE (1999)

KLAWANS, IMPURITY AND SIN

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHO INSPECTS BODIES IN DOMINION, AND WHAT THEY'RE AUTHORIZED TO DECLARE

CONTENT NOTE Menstruation, childbirth and the regulation of women's bodies by religious law.

Chapter 12 and chapter 15

Two chapters govern access after childbirth and during discharges, for women and for men. Read them together. The male provisions are there, and they're usually left out of any sermon on the female ones.

AFTER A BIRTH	Impure seven days after a son, then thirty-three more before she may touch holy things or enter the sanctuary. For a daughter both numbers double, to fourteen and sixty-six. The text gives no reason. Every explanation you've heard is interpretation.
THE OFFERING AFTER	A lamb and a bird. If she can't afford a lamb, two birds will do (12.8). The concession is written into the law, which means the law expects poor women to use it. Luke records Mary bringing the poorer offering (Luke 2.22–24).
MEN IN CHAPTER 15	Matching sections for men and women: abnormal male discharge, emission, intercourse, menstruation and abnormal female bleeding. A man with an abnormal discharge brings the same two birds as a woman with abnormal bleeding. After intercourse both are impure until evening. The chapter states its purpose, to keep the people from defiling the tabernacle among them (15.31).
WHAT IT ISN'T	These states aren't punishments or sins. They're conditions with a procedure. **INTERPRETATION** Whether the system still weighs more heavily on women in practice is a fair question, and a separate one from what the text calls it.
RECEPTION	Later Jewish law developed these rules into a detailed practice with its own debates, and churches developed their own customs about women after childbirth. Don't read either back into Leviticus. The woman with bleeding who touches Jesus' clothes lives under 15.25–30 (Mark 5).

THE USEFUL QUESTION FOR TKC

INTERPRETATION The question is who runs the calendar. An empire that decides when a woman may enter a building has an instrument for scheduling her whole life, and can attach a fee to it.

LEV 12

LEV 15.1–18

LEV 15.19–33

LUKE 2.22–24

MARK 5.25–34

MILGROM, LEVITICUS 1–16

TKC: DOM

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHAT MY WORLD DOES WITH A WOMAN'S BODY AND A CALENDAR

One day, two goats

Once a year the high priest enters the innermost space, after washings and changes of clothes, and the sanctuary itself is cleansed of a year's accumulated contamination. Two goats are chosen by lot. One is offered. Over the other the high priest confesses the people's sins with both hands on its head, and it's sent alive into the wilderness. The day applies to the resident foreigner as well as the native.

WHAT'S BEING CLEANSED	The building, first. Blood is sprinkled to cleanse the sanctuary "because of the uncleannesses of the people of Israel and their transgressions" (16.16). Sin has a physical residue here, and it collects where God is said to live. The people's atonement follows.
THE GOAT THAT LEAVES	The second goat is "for Azazel." CONTESTED: Tyndale coined "scapegoat" in 1530, reading "the goat that departs." Others propose a place name for a rugged cliff, a wilderness demon (Azazel is a fallen angel in 1 Enoch), or an abstract noun for complete removal. Don't read the modern social meaning of "scapegoat" back into the verse.
CONFESSION ALOUD	The high priest confesses on behalf of the whole people, in public, and the assembly does no work and denies itself. A national accounting on a fixed date, performed by the highest office in everyone's hearing.
TWO PRIESTS DIED IN CHAPTER 10	The chapter opens "after the death of the two sons of Aaron." Nadab and Abihu offered fire they weren't commanded to offer, and fire consumed them. Aaron was silent and was forbidden to mourn in public. The system that follows was written by people for whom improvising at the altar was lethal.
RECEPTION	Later Jewish tradition made Yom Kippur the year's central day of repentance without a temple, and Hebrews reads the chapter through Christ. Both are receptions of Leviticus 16.

DOMINION'S ANNUAL ACCOUNTING. WHO CONFESSES, WHO'S SENT OUT, AND WHO WATCHES

LEV 10.1–9

LEV 16

LEV 16.16

LEV 16.29

LEV 23.26–32

1 ENOCH 8–10

HEB 9 (RECEPTION)

MILGROM, LEVITICUS 1–16

TKC: SANCTUM

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

DOMINION'S ANNUAL ACCOUNTING. WHO CONFESSES, WHO'S SENT OUT, AND WHO WATCHES

CONTENT NOTE Sexual prohibitions, incest, capital penalties, and the modern use of two verses against gay people. The page reports the text and the state of the argument and doesn't settle your theology for you.

The two verses and the rest of the list

Chapter 18 is addressed to Israelite men and opens by refusing the practices of Egypt and Canaan. Most of it is forbidden unions with kin, set out from the man's side. A man's own daughter isn't named, which scholars have explained in different ways. Chapter 20 assigns penalties, often death.

WHAT'S IN THE LIST	Close kin by blood and marriage, a wife's sister as a rival while the wife lives, sex during menstruation, a neighbor's wife, giving children to Molech, lying with a male "as with a woman," and sex with animals, the only verse that makes a woman the one acting.
"ABOMINATION"	*To'evah* covers the whole list. It's used elsewhere for unclean food, dishonest weights and a lying tongue. The English carries a revulsion the Hebrew may not.
THE SELECTION TEST	**INTERPRETATION** Anyone citing chapter 18 as binding is also citing the menstruation clause, and is standing seven chapters from the debt release. Consistency is a question about the reader.

CONTESTED 18.22 AND 20.13	WHAT IT HOLDS	ASSOCIATED WITH
A GENERAL PROHIBITION	All sexual relations between men, carried forward in the New Testament (Rom 1, 1 Cor 6)	Robert Gagnon (2001), and most historic church teaching
A SPECIFIC ACT	The phrasing points narrowly to anal intercourse between men	Saul Olyan (1994). Milgrom also limited it to that act and to Israelite men in the land.
THE CODE'S OWN CONCERNS	Read inside a system organized around lineage, seed and category boundaries	Various, building on Douglas
APPLICABILITY	Whether the Holiness Code binds Christians at all, and by what principle some laws are kept	The moral, ceremonial and civil division, and its critics

LEV 18
LEV 20
GEN 43.32
DEUT 14.3
DEUT 25.16
PROV 6.16–19
GAGNON (2001)
OLYAN (1994)
MILGROM, LEVITICUS 17–22

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHICH VERSES DOMINION MADE STATUTE, AND WHICH IT LEFT AS SCRIPTURE

The chapter nobody quotes whole

"Love your neighbor as yourself" sits in the middle of a chapter of labor law, harvest law, court procedure and protection for disabled people. In context it's the summary clause of a list of concrete obligations. The chapter opens "You shall be holy, for I the LORD your God am holy" and puts ritual and ethics side by side without ranking them. Revere your mother and father, mother first.

THE HARVEST EDGE	Don't reap to the border of the field, don't strip the vineyard, leave what falls for the poor and the foreigner. A standing claim on private production, collected by the poor themselves. Ruth gleans under this law.
WAGES THE SAME DAY	A hired worker's pay may not be held overnight. Wage theft is named beside robbery.
DISABILITY	Don't curse the deaf or put a stumbling block before the blind, harms the victim can't see coming or answer. Compare chapter 21, the same book with a different logic.
COURTS AND SPEECH	No partiality to great or poor, no slander, and don't stand by while your neighbor's blood is shed. Reprove openly instead of hating in your heart. Confrontation is commanded as the alternative to a grudge.
THE FOREIGNER	Treated as a native, "and you shall love him as yourself, for you were foreigners in Egypt." The famous command appears twice, and the second time it's about immigrants.
HONEST WEIGHTS	Just balances, weights and measures. Commercial fraud closes the chapter that holds the love command.

> **AN ENSLAVED WOMAN, 19.20–22**
>
> Content note. A man who lies with an enslaved woman promised to another man isn't put to death, "because she was not free." There's an inquiry or a penalty (the word is disputed), and he brings a reparation offering. The text says nothing about her.

LEV 19.2–3

LEV 19.9–10

LEV 19.13–18

LEV 19.20–22

LEV 19.33–36

MARK 12.31

RUTH 2

MILGROM, LEVITICUS 17–22

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHERE THE HARVEST EDGE WOULD BE IN MY WORLD, AND WHO FENCED IT

Land, debt and release

Every seventh year the land rests. In the fiftieth year, by proclamation, holdings go back to the families that lost them and people in debt service go home. The stated ground is ownership. Land isn't sold permanently because it isn't the seller's to sell, "for the land is mine, and you are foreigners and sojourners with me" (25.23).

THE SABBATH YEAR	No sowing, no reaping, no harvesting the vines. What grows feeds the household, the workers, the hired laborer, the resident foreigner, the livestock and the wild animals alike.
THE FIFTIETH YEAR	Proclaimed with a horn on the Day of Atonement: liberty throughout the land. The economic reset is announced on the day of national confession, which ties the two together on purpose.
PRICE MECHANICS	Sale prices are counted by the number of harvests left until the release. What changes hands is a lease of crops more than the land itself. Debt is designed to expire. Houses in walled cities are an exception.
NO INTEREST	Take no interest from a poor kinsman, and support him so he can live beside you. One who sells himself is to be treated as a hired worker until the Jubilee.
REDEMPTION DUTY	A kinsman may and should buy back a relative's land or freedom. Rescue is a family obligation with a legal form, the machinery Ruth runs on.
THE BOUNDARY IN IT	The protections are for kin. The same chapter lets Israel buy slaves from the nations and from resident foreigners, pass them on as inheritance and "make them slaves forever" (25.44–46). Print it whenever the Jubilee is praised.
WAS IT PRACTICED	Sabbath years are attested in the Second Temple period. There's no clear record of a Jubilee being kept. **CONTESTED** Whether it was enacted law, a utopian program or an ideal invoked now and then.

WHY AN EMPIRE CAN'T CIRCULATE THIS CHAPTER

INTERPRETATION A permanent land market and inheritable debt are the two ways a household gets captured for generations. Chapter 25 forbids both among kin and grounds the ban in the deliverance the Empire also claims. It can't be denied and can't be taught, so it goes to the closed catechism.

LEV 25.1–7

LEV 25.8–17

LEV 25.23–28

LEV 25.35–46

NEH 10.31

1 MACC 6.49, 53

BERGSMA, THE JUBILEE FROM LEVITICUS TO QUMRAN

TKC: DOM · MEN

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHICH HOUSEHOLD IN MY CAST A JUBILEE WOULD FREE, AND WHO WOULD LOSE BY IT

Build the suppression

Dominion can't delete a chapter its own scripture contains. It has to manage it: restrict it, spiritualize it, postpone it, or attach conditions that never arrive. Draft the mechanism here.

1 · THE OFFICIAL TEACHING ON DEBT RELEASE, IN THE SANCTUM'S VOICE

2 · THE CONDITION ATTACHED TO IT THAT CAN NEVER BE MET

3 · A CHARACTER WHO READS CHAPTER 25 FOR THE FIRST TIME. WRITE THE SCENE

4 · THE HARVEST EDGE AND THE SAME-DAY WAGE AS DOMINION LABOR LAW. WHAT REPLACED THEM

WRITING

LEV 19

LEV 25

TKC: DOM · SANCTUM

LEV 21.1–15

LEV 21.16–24

LEV 22.10–16

LEV 22.20–25

LEV 19.14

ISA 56.3–5

OLYAN, DISABILITY IN THE HEBREW BIBLE (2008)

TKC: TR

The body of the official

Chapter 21 limits who may serve at the altar by descent, marriage, mourning and body. A priest with a listed condition may eat the holy food and may not officiate. The rule concerns how the sanctuary presents itself, and it shuts a class of people out of an office because of their bodies. Both halves of that sentence belong on the page.

THE LIST	A man who's blind or lame, has a marked face or a limb too long, a broken foot or hand, a hunched back, dwarfism, a defect of the eye, scabs or crushed testicles. The same word, *mum*, marks animals unfit for sacrifice. Interpreters note the symmetry between offerer, offering and officiant, which explains the logic without justifying it.
HELD AGAINST CHAPTER 19	The book that protects the deaf and the blind from harm bars them from the priesthood. It's a real tension inside Leviticus, and the honest move is to name it. Isaiah 56 later promises eunuchs a name in God's house better than sons and daughters.
MARRIAGE AND MOURNING	Limits on whom a priest may marry, tighter for the high priest, and on which dead he may mourn. A priest's daughter who becomes a prostitute is to be burned (21.9). Office reaches into the household and the funeral.
WHAT PRIESTS LIVE ON	Set portions of the offerings, shared with their households and closed to outsiders. The sanctuary is also a payroll, and the text isn't embarrassed about it.

> **FOR DOMINION**
>
> **POSSIBLE** An empire choosing candidates for a public religious role has this chapter as precedent for physical screening, and the Trials are that kind of selection. Whether the Sanctum cites Leviticus 21 for its examinations is a plot decision.

WHAT DISQUALIFIES A BODY FROM SERVICE IN MY WORLD, AND WHO WROTE THE LIST

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHAT DISQUALIFIES A BODY FROM SERVICE IN MY WORLD, AND WHO WROTE THE LIST

METHOD

BIBLE 101 VIII

LEV 25.8–17

LEV 19.9–15

One passage, worked properly

Choose one passage and run the method across this spread. If you want one chosen, try 25.8–17, the Jubilee proclamation, or 19.9–15, the harvest edge and the wage.

PASSAGE

TRANSLATION USED

1 · WHAT IT SAYS. SUMMARIZE WITHOUT INTERPRETING. NO CONCLUSIONS YET

2 · WHO IS ADDRESSED, WHO IS DISCUSSED AND WHO IS ABSENT

3 · WHERE TWO TRANSLATIONS DIFFER, AND WHAT TURNS ON THE DIFFERENCE

How it's been used

4 · HOW THIS PASSAGE HAS BEEN USED AGAINST SOMEONE, AND WHO BENEFITED

5 · WHAT IT COSTS THE PERSON WITH PROPERTY, IF IT'S ACTUALLY KEPT

6 · WHAT DOMINION WOULD DO WITH IT. CIRCULATE, RESTRICT OR SPIRITUALIZE

7 · WHAT I'M TAKING INTO THE MANUSCRIPT, AND WHICH CHAPTER

Anything found on these two pages begins as POSSIBLE. Move it to DECIDED only after deciding it belongs in the manuscript and logging where it affects the existing files.

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED LOG NO. DATE

ISA 61.1–2

LUKE 4.16–21

ACTS 15

AQUINAS, ST I–II Q. 99

WESTMINSTER CONFESSION (1646) 19

BERGSMA, THE JUBILEE

A BOOK USED IN TWO DIRECTIONS

Everything here is reception, what people did with Leviticus.

INSIDE THE BIBLE	The release language of chapter 25 comes back in Isaiah 61, and Luke has Jesus read that passage in the synagogue at Nazareth and say it's fulfilled today (Luke 4.16–21). The Jubilee is quoted as a program.
JEWISH PRACTICE	Rabbinic Judaism developed the purity, dietary and agricultural laws into living practice and argument, sabbatical-year observance included. Treating Leviticus as a dead text is a Christian habit.
EARLY CHRISTIAN USE	In Acts 15 the church decided which of these laws applied to non-Jewish believers. Thomas Aquinas later divided the law into moral, ceremonial and judicial precepts, and the Westminster Confession (1646) made the division Reformed doctrine. The text doesn't contain it, and it's how chapter 18 is kept and chapter 25 dropped.
THE LIBERTY BELL	Cast for the Pennsylvania State House in 1752 and recast in 1753 with 25.10 on it. Abolitionists adopted it in the 1830s. The *Anti-Slavery Record* called it the Liberty Bell in 1835, and a poem in Garrison's *Liberator* in 1839 spread the name.
DEBT CAMPAIGNS	The Jubilee 2000 campaign for cancelling the debts of the poorest countries took its name and its argument from chapter 25.
PURITY AS INSULT	"Unclean" and "leper" have long been used outside the sanctuary system for people a community wants to keep out, by race, disease or sexuality. The most consequential misuse of the book.

CORRECTION TO THE OLD COMPANION The old companion said the word "jubilee" is on the bell. It isn't. The bell reads "Proclaim LIBERTY Throughout all the Land unto all the Inhabitants Thereof," with the reference Lev. XXV. v X. Its debt reading also needed fixing: the Jubilee returns land and frees Israelites in debt service, and the seventh-year debt release is Deuteronomy 15.

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHERE I'VE HEARD PURITY LANGUAGE USED ABOUT A PERSON

LEV 19.9–15

LEV 25

LEV 6.1–7

TKC: DOM · SANCTUM

The half the Empire teaches

POSSIBLE Everything on this page is a TKC construction to test against the manuscript.

WHAT THE SANCTUM CIRCULATES	WHAT IT KEEPS IN THE CLOSED CATECHISM
HOLINESS AS PERSONAL PURITY, AND THE SEXUAL PROHIBITIONS AS HOUSEHOLD LAW	Chapter 25 entire. Land returned, debts ended, servitude ended by proclamation.
LOVE YOUR NEIGHBOR, AS A DISPOSITION	The harvest edge, the same-day wage and the ban on interest that define what the love requires
INSPECTION, QUARANTINE AND READMISSION AS PUBLIC HEALTH AND PUBLIC ORDER	Impurity in the source text is temporary, recurring, mostly non-moral, and applies to priests too
ATONEMENT AS AN ANNUAL ACT OF SUBMISSION, SCHEDULED BY THE SANCTUM	The rite cleanses the sanctuary of what the institution itself has accumulated
RESTITUTION AS AN OFFERING PAID TO THE TEMPLE	The defrauded person is paid first, in full, plus a fifth, before any offering counts

THE ARGUMENT IN ONE PARAGRAPH

INTERPRETATION Dominion doesn't need to falsify Leviticus. It teaches chapters 11 through 20 and shelves 19.9–15 and chapter 25, keeping the machinery of exclusion and dropping the machinery of release. A character who reads the whole book finds the Empire's own scripture arguing against it, a stronger plot device than any invented heresy.

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHO IN MY CAST WOULD RATHER NOT HAVE HEARD CHAPTER 25 READ ALOUD

WRITING

DOSSIER CLOSE

QUEUE: D3

What I take out of Leviticus

THE ONE THING THIS BOOK CHANGED ABOUT HOW I SEE DOMINION

WHAT I STILL DON'T UNDERSTAND. CARRY IT TO THE RESEARCH LIST.

A CLAUSE I'M TAKING STRAIGHT INTO THE MANUSCRIPT, AND WHERE

PROOFING GATE *log only, nothing is closed here*

Dossier III has fifteen numbered pages, with content notes on pages 3, 4, 6 and 7, and 18.22 carried as CONTESTED with no verdict printed. Outstanding for proofing: full citations with edition and year.

PROOFED BY | DATE | OUTSTANDING

NOTES

OPEN NOTES

ANYTHING THIS DOSSIER STARTED AND DIDN'T FINISH

IV

DEEP-DIVE DOSSIER

Deuteronomy

A speech given by a man who isn't allowed to arrive

The Law of the King

DEUTERONOMY 17.14–20

TO BE COPIED IN THE KING'S OWN HAND, IN THE PRESENCE OF THE PRIESTS, AND READ ALL THE DAYS OF HIS LIFE

HORSES	*not many, and none bought by sending the people back to Egypt*
WIVES	*not many, "lest his heart turn away"*
SILVER AND GOLD	*not in great quantity*
THE COPY	*written by the king himself and kept with him*
THE REASON	*that his heart may not be lifted up above his brothers*

Six verses, and no enforcement clause. Solomon breaks all four prohibitions (1 Kgs 3.1, 10.27–29, 11.3).

NOT ENFORCED

SOURCE MARGIN

DEUT 1–34

MT · LXX · 4QDEUT

WEINFELD, DEUTERONOMY 1–11 (AB)

LEVINSON, DEUTERONOMY AND THE HERMENEUTICS OF LEGAL INNOVATION

DEEP-DIVE DOSSIER IV · ✣

Deuteronomy

The book that tells a nation how to be a nation, one sanctuary, one archive, a king held under the law and debts that expire, and the most dangerous book in the Torah for an empire to let people read whole.

WHY A FULL DOSSIER

The audit gives it a dossier on three grounds. It's a constitution, it holds the law that limits a king, and it supplies both the enforcement machinery and the conquest language Dominion runs on.

HOW TO WORK IT

Reference is about a third of these pages, and the rest is yours. Three pages carry content notes. Skip them if you need to, and the dossier still works.

DEUT 1.1

DEUT 1–11

DEUT 12–26

DEUT 27–34

DEUT 17.18

2 KGS 22–23

WEINFELD, DEUTERONOMY AND THE DEUTERONOMIC SCHOOL (1972)

TKC: DOM

What it is

NAME	English from the Greek *deuteronomion*, "second law." It's a mistranslation. In 17.18 the king is told to write "a copy of this law," *mishneh hattorah hazzot*, and the Greek translators rendered it "this second law." Hebrew *Devarim*, "words."
PLACE	The fifth and last book of the Torah, set on the plains of Moab on the last day of Moses' life. Nothing happens. The book is speech, and then a death, and a grave no one knows (34.5–6).
JOSIAH'S SCROLL	In 2 Kings 22–23, during temple repairs under Josiah, about 622 BCE, the high priest finds "the book of the law." The king tears his clothes, sends to the prophet Huldah, who authenticates it, and purges the outlying shrines. W. M. L. de Wette argued in 1805 that the scroll was a form of Deuteronomy. CONTESTED Whether the core was written for the reform, came south after 722 BCE, or was shaped largely in and after the exile. Traditional readers attribute the book to Moses.
STRUCTURE	1–4, a retelling of the wilderness. 5–11, the commandments, the Shema and the sermon on loyalty. 12–26, the law code. 27–28, blessings and curses. 29–30, covenant renewal. 31–34, succession, a song, a blessing and a grave.
GENRE	A sermon wrapped around a law code, shaped like an ancient treaty between a great king and a subject people.
A WARNING	The book holds the most quoted verse about loving God and the most brutal commands about conquest, in the same speech, from the same mouth. A presentation that gives you one without the other is selling something.

WHAT THE BOOK IS ACTUALLY ABOUT

INTERPRETATION Memory as a political instrument. Almost every command comes with a reason that starts "remember that you were a slave." The book's theory is that a people who forget where they came from will build what they escaped.

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHAT I WAS TAUGHT DEUTERONOMY WAS, AND WHETHER ANYONE TOLD ME IT WAS A CONSTITUTION

DEUT 1–3

DEUT 28

DEUT 31.9–13

ESARHADDON SUCCESSION TREATY (COMPARE)

MORAN (1963)

WEINFELD, DEUTERONOMIC SCHOOL

TKC: DOM · SANCTUM

A LOYALTY OATH, REVERSED

Assyrian and Hittite kings bound subject peoples with documents of a recognizable type. Deuteronomy has the same parts in roughly the same order, with one substitution. The great king is God, and the human monarch is demoted into the text as a regulated official. INTERPRETATION The substitution is the book's central political act.

TREATY PART	WHAT IT DOES	IN DEUTERONOMY
PREAMBLE	Names the sovereign and the setting	1.1–5
HISTORICAL PROLOGUE	Recounts what the sovereign has done, so the terms arrive as gratitude. It differs from Exodus and Numbers in places, and the differences are the argument.	1.6–4.43
GENERAL STIPULATION	Exclusive loyalty, called "love." William Moran showed in 1963 that "love" in treaties names political loyalty.	5–11, the Shema at 6.4–5
SPECIFIC STIPULATIONS	The code: sanctuary, officers, courts, king, priests, prophets, war, property, debt, family, harvest	12–26
DEPOSIT AND READING	Stored beside the ark and read aloud every seventh year, at the feast of Booths, to men, women, children and foreigners	10.1–5, 31.9–13
WITNESSES	Heaven and earth, and a song to be memorized	4.26, 30.19, 31.19, 32.1
BLESSINGS AND CURSES	Enforcement	27–28

WHICH TREATIES

Whether the closer model is the Hittite treaties of the second millennium (Mendenhall), which would support an early date, or the Neo-Assyrian treaties of the seventh century (Weinfeld), which fit Josiah's time.

WHY THE FORM MATTERS FOR TKC

INTERPRETATION If you want to build a state religion, this is the template, and the template is neutral. The same seven parts produce a covenant that limits the king or a loyalty oath that makes him a god, depending on who is named in the preamble. Dominion changes one line and keeps the rest.

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

DOMINION'S FOUNDING DOCUMENT. WHO IS IN THE PREAMBLE, AND WHO WITNESSES

DEUT 6.4–9

DEUT 6.10–12

DEUT 6.20–21

DEUT 5.6–21

EXOD 20.8–11 (COMPARE)

DEUT 8.17

MARK 12.29–30

THE HOUSEHOLD IS THE SCHOOL

The book's most famous passage is a loyalty clause followed by a method. Keep these words on your heart, teach them to your children, talk about them sitting in your house and walking on the road, lying down and rising, bind them on your hand and write them on your doorposts and gates. It's a curriculum with a delivery schedule, located in the house more than the sanctuary.

WHERE TEACHING SITS	With parents, in domestic time, in ordinary conversation. No priest appears, and no building. **INTERPRETATION** An institution that wants a monopoly on teaching has to get around chapter 6, not cite it.
THE CHILD'S QUESTION	When a child asks what the laws mean, the answer is a story: "We were Pharaoh's slaves in Egypt" (6.20–21). The catechism is historical. The reason for the law is a memory of servitude.
TWO DECALOGUES	Deuteronomy 5 repeats the ten words with real differences. Exodus says "remember" the sabbath and Deuteronomy says "observe." Exodus grounds it in creation, and Deuteronomy in slavery, "that your male and female slave may rest as well as you." Deuteronomy's coveting command puts the wife first, gives her her own verb and adds the neighbor's field.
THE PROSPERITY WARNING	Right after the teaching method: when you live in houses you didn't build and eat from vines you didn't plant, you'll forget (6.10–12). Later, don't say "my power and the might of my hand have gotten me this wealth" (8.17). The book's named enemy is comfort.
RECEPTION	The verses became a fixed recitation in Judaism, and Jesus names them the first commandment (Mark 12.29–30). Both are receptions of Deuteronomy 6.

WHO IS ALLOWED TO TEACH A CHILD IN MY WORLD, AND WHAT HAPPENS IN THE HOUSE INSTEAD

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHO IS ALLOWED TO TEACH A CHILD IN MY WORLD, AND WHAT HAPPENS IN THE HOUSE INSTEAD

DEUT 12

DEUT 14.22–29

DEUT 18.6–8

DEUT 26.12

2 KGS 23.9

LEVINSON, LEGAL INNOVATION

TKC: SANCTUM

Centralization and its price

Chapter 12 abolishes local altars and requires sacrifice at one chosen place. The single provision reorganizes a society. It moves worship away from the village, concentrates revenue, leaves a class of local priests without altars and turns pilgrimage into infrastructure. The chapter then works through the consequences, which makes it legislation.

THE RULE	Sacrifice only at "the place the LORD your God will choose." Local shrines are to be destroyed. Jerusalem is never named.
MEAT BECOMES SECULAR	Since you can't slaughter at a local altar any more, ordinary slaughter at home is allowed. Eat meat in your towns, and pour out the blood. A monopoly at the center creates a whole area of life the sanctuary no longer touches.
TITHE INTO COIN	If the journey's too long, sell the tithe, carry the money and buy "whatever you desire, oxen or sheep or wine or strong drink," and eat it there with the household and the Levite. A tax in kind turned into currency for logistical reasons, and the text says so.
THE THIRD-YEAR TITHE	Every third year the tithe stays in the town for the Levite, the foreigner, the fatherless and the widow. A centralized system with a mandatory local redistribution valve built in.
THE DISPLACED PRIESTS	Local Levites without altars appear again and again among the dependents "within your gates." A Levite who comes to the central place may serve there equally (18.6–8). In Josiah's reform the shrine priests didn't serve at the Jerusalem altar (2 Kgs 23.9), so the law and the history don't match.

THE MECHANISM WORTH STEALING

POSSIBLE One authorized place, one authorized calendar, and travel required to comply. Attendance becomes traceable, absence becomes evidence, and the road becomes a tax. Dominion doesn't need to invent a Sanctum monopoly. It keeps chapter 12 and loses chapter 14's local tithe.

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHAT THE JOURNEY TO THE CENTER COSTS A POOR HOUSEHOLD IN MY WORLD

DEUT 17.14–20

DEUT 16.18–20

DEUT 18.15–22

1 SAM 8

1 KGS 3.1

1 KGS 10.27–29

1 KGS 11.3

TKC: DOM · MEN

The king under the text

INTERPRETATION Six verses, and the most politically radical passage in the Torah. Monarchy is permitted, conditionally, and then stripped. The office is placed under a document.

HOW THE KING ARRIVES	By popular demand, "like all the nations around me," then by God's choice, and from among the people, not a foreigner. Kingship is a concession framed as copying the neighbors.
THE FOUR PROHIBITIONS	Horses, Egypt, wives and treasure. Read as policy: no standing cavalry, no military alliance with Egypt, no network of dynastic marriages, no royal hoard. They're the four instruments of ancient state power.
THE COPYING CLAUSE	He writes out the law in a scroll before the priests and keeps it with him. A sovereign who has to copy out the limits on his own office, and reread them, can't claim not to know them.
THE STATED REASON	"That his heart may not be lifted up above his brothers." Neither efficiency nor piety. The reason is anti-hierarchical, and it's written into the clause.
THE OTHER OFFICES	Judges, priests and prophets are each limited in the surrounding chapters: no bribes, no partiality, a test for false prophecy, portions in place of estates. Chapter 17 sits inside a scheme that spreads authority out and checks it.
WHAT'S MISSING	No enforcement. Nobody is named who can remove a king who breaks the list, which is the flaw every later empire uses. Solomon breaks all four: horses from Egypt, Pharaoh's daughter and seven hundred wives, and silver "as common as stone."

THE CENTRAL TKC FINDING

POSSIBLE The Empire's own scripture forbids the Emperor to pile up wealth, weapons and wives and requires him to copy the law by hand. Dominion can't delete it, so it reinterprets it, most likely by declaring the Emperor exempt as the law's author and not its subject. The move is the theological center of the Empire, and it's available to any character who can read.

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHICH OF THE FOUR PROHIBITIONS MY EMPEROR BREAKS MOST VISIBLY, AND WHO NOTICED

DEUT 15.1–11

DEUT 15.12–18

DEUT 23.15–16

DEUT 24.10–15

EXOD 21.7 (COMPARE)

HAMMURABI §§15–20

JER 34

NEH 5

MARK 14.7

TKC: DOM

Debt with an expiry date

Every seventh year, release. Debts between Israelites are cancelled, and debt servants go free, and not empty-handed. The master has to load them with livestock, grain and wine, because you were slaves and were brought out. The chapter also closes the obvious loophole: don't refuse a loan because the seventh year is near.

THE RELEASE	Creditors release what they've lent to a fellow Israelite. A foreigner's debt can still be collected, and the text says so. Print the limit with the promise.
TWO SENTENCES THAT DISAGREE	"There will be no poor among you" (15.4) and "the poor will never cease out of the land" (15.11), a few verses apart. The first is conditional on obedience, and the second is the reason to open your hand. Jesus quotes the second (Mark 14.7).
THE HARD-HEART CLAUSE	Don't harden your heart or shut your hand, and don't let your eye be hostile because the release is coming. Reluctance is named as a sin, which means the drafters expected it.

Debt with an expiry date, continued

SEVERANCE	A Hebrew man or woman freed in the seventh year leaves with provisions from the flock, the threshing floor and the winepress. Freedom made survivable. **CONTESTED** Whether this revises Exodus 21.7, which kept a sold daughter from going free, or addresses a different case.
THE ONE WHO STAYS	An awl through the ear at the door, "and to your female slave you shall do the same." Consent is provided for and then made permanent and visible.
RUNAWAYS · 23.15–16	An escaped slave who takes refuge with you isn't returned and may live wherever he chooses. The Code of Hammurabi made harboring a runaway a capital offense.
WAS IT PRACTICED	In Jeremiah 34, Jerusalem frees its slaves under siege and then takes them back, and Jeremiah answers with a "release" to the sword. Nehemiah 5 settles a debt crisis under pressure. The law was invoked, and there's no evidence of it working as designed.

HELD BESIDE LEVITICUS 25

INTERPRETATION Leviticus returns land every fiftieth year, and Deuteronomy cancels debt every seventh. Two instruments aimed at the same failure, the permanent capture of a household. Together they make generational poverty illegal, which is why an empire teaches neither.

HOW DEBT PASSES TO A CHILD IN MY WORLD, AND WHO WROTE THAT RULE

DEUT 15.1–11

DEUT 15.12–18

DEUT 23.15–16

DEUT 24.10–15

EXOD 21.7 (COMPARE)

HAMMURABI §§15–20

JER 34

NEH 5

MARK 14.7

TKC: DOM

DEUT 7.1–6

DEUT 20

DEUT 21.10–14

JUDG 1

JOSH 6–11 (RECEPTION)

MESHA STELE (C. 840 BCE)

KENYON, JERICHO (1950S)

KITCHEN · HOFFMEIER

CONTENT NOTE Commanded killing, the destruction of civilian populations including children, siege warfare and the taking of captive women. The page reports the text and the state of the argument and doesn't resolve it for you.

The commands nobody embroiders

The book that says love the foreigner because you were foreigners also orders the total destruction of seven named peoples. Both are in it, and a companion that prints one and hides the other isn't a companion.

THE DEVOTED THING	*Ḥerem*, often "utterly destroy," marks persons or property removed from ordinary use by destruction. It isn't unique to Israel. The Moabite king Mesha's inscription, about 840 BCE, boasts of devoting an Israelite town to his god and killing seven thousand people.
TWO RULES OF WAR	A distant city is offered peace first. If it accepts, its people become forced labor. If not, its men are killed and the women, children and livestock taken. The cities of the land itself are to leave nothing alive that breathes. The law is two-tier, with the harsher tier for the nearest neighbors.
THE STATED REASON	Contamination: "they would turn away your sons from following me," and "that they may not teach you." The justification is ideological containment, the one purges have used since. The same chapter forbids marrying these peoples, which assumes they'll still be there.
EXEMPTIONS AND THE TREES	Men with a new house, an unharvested vineyard, a fiancée, or fear are sent home before battle. Fruit trees may not be cut down in a siege: "Are the trees in the field human, that they should be besieged by you?" Restraint and annihilation, drafted on the same page.

The commands nobody embroiders, continued

THE CAPTIVE WOMAN · 21.10–14	She shaves her head, cuts her nails, puts off her captive's clothes and mourns her father and mother a month before marriage. If he later doesn't want her, he must let her go where she wants and may not sell her, "since you have humbled her." CONTESTED: Mitigation or legitimation. Both readings are serious.
DID IT HAPPEN	**CONTESTED** Archaeology doesn't support a sweeping conquest. Kathleen Kenyon's Jericho excavations and the work at Ai found no city of the right period matching the account, and many see Israel emerging gradually in the central highlands. Judges 1 itself lists peoples not driven out. Kenneth Kitchen, James Hoffmeier and others defend more of the narrative. If the commands were written long after as ideology, that explains their origin and doesn't soften the words.

WHAT DOMINION DOES WITH A DIVINE WAR COMMAND, AND WHICH OF MY CHARACTERS CARRIED IT OUT

DEUT 7.1–6

DEUT 20

DEUT 21.10–14

JUDG 1

JOSH 6–11 (RECEPTION)

MESHA STELE (C. 840 BCE)

KENYON, JERICHO (1950S)

KITCHEN · HOFFMEIER

DEUT 22.13–29

DEUT 24.1–4

DEUT 24.5

DEUT 24.17–22

EXOD 22.16–17

M. GITTIN 9.10

MATT 19.3–9

MIDDLE ASSYRIAN LAWS A 55

HAMMURABI §130

CONTENT NOTE Rape law, virginity evidence, capital penalties and divorce, including a clause that compels marriage to an assailant.

Whose property is injured

The sexual and family laws are addressed to men and largely built around damage to a household's standing. Read as an ethic of consent they make no sense. Read as property and lineage law they make a coherent and disturbing system.

THE CLOTH	A husband who claims his bride wasn't a virgin goes before the elders, and her parents bring out the cloth from the wedding night. If his charge is false, he pays a hundred shekels to her father and can never divorce her. If it's true, she's stoned. Her reputation is treated as her father's asset and her body as evidence.
THE FIELD AND THE CITY	If a betrothed woman lies with another man in the city, both die, on the reasoning that she didn't cry out. In the field only the man dies, because "she cried out and there was no one to rescue her." Geography stands in for testimony.
THE FIFTY SHEKELS	A man who seizes an unbetrothed virgin pays her father fifty shekels, must marry her and can never divorce her. Exodus 22 lets the father refuse the marriage, and Deuteronomy doesn't mention refusal. Naming this plainly is reading the clause.
DIVORCE	A husband who finds "some indecency" in his wife may write a certificate and send her away. She may remarry, and she can't go back to him. The certificate lets her prove she's free, and only he can start it. The house of Shammai allowed divorce only for unchastity, and the house of Hillel for anything, even a spoiled dish. Jesus is asked about this verse.
WHAT CUTS THE OTHER WAY	The same chapters exempt a new husband from war for a year "to be happy with his wife," forbid taking a widow's garment in pledge, and leave harvest for the widow and orphan. Protection and subordination are the same code here.
HOW TO CITE IT HONESTLY	The Middle Assyrian Laws let a raped virgin's father hand the rapist's own wife over to be raped. Hammurabi executes a man who rapes a betrothed virgin and declares her blameless. "Better than its neighbors" and "good" are different claims, and some neighbors weren't worse.

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHICH OF THESE CLAUSES DOMINION KEPT AS STATUTE, AND WHO IS STANDING AT THE GATE

WRITING

DEUT 17

DEUT 15

DEUT 31.9–13

TKC: DOM · MEN

Write the exemption

Dominion holds a scripture that forbids its Emperor to hoard, to marry widely and to arm without limit, and requires him to copy the law by hand. Build the doctrine that makes the clause harmless without denying it.

1 · THE SANCTUM'S OFFICIAL READING OF THE LAW OF THE KING, IN ITS OWN VOICE

2 · THE COPYING RITE AS THEATER. WHAT THE EMPEROR ACTUALLY WRITES OUT, AND WHO HOLDS THE PEN

3 · THE SCENE WHERE SOMEONE READS THE FOUR PROHIBITIONS ALOUD AT COURT

4 · THE PUBLIC READING EVERY SEVEN YEARS. WHAT DOMINION PUT IN ITS PLACE

CONTENT NOTE Siege famine and cannibalism, 28.53–57.

Enforcement

Twelve curses are pronounced from Mount Ebal, and the people answer "Amen" to each. Consent to the penalty clause is gathered in public, out loud.

THE TWELVE CURSES	An idol made in secret, a boundary stone moved, a blind man sent the wrong way, justice perverted for the foreigner, the orphan and the widow. Almost every one names an act done where nobody can see. The curse list handles offenses that slip past the courts.
THE ASYMMETRY	Blessings take fourteen verses (28.1–14). Curses take fifty-four (28.15–68), a little under four times as many: disease, siege, deportation, madness, a famine where parents eat their children, and the people shipped back to Egypt for sale with no buyer. **INTERPRETATION** A document that spends that many words on punishment is telling you what its drafters expected to need.
THE ASSYRIAN PARALLEL	Several curses closely match Esarhaddon's Succession Treaty (672 BCE), known from copies at Nimrud and one found at Tell Tayinat in 2009, the sky as bronze and the earth as iron among them. **CONTESTED** Hans Ulrich Steymans argues 28.20–44 borrows directly. Others think the shared language came through common treaty convention.
CHAPTER 13	Report and execute even a brother, son, daughter, wife or friend who secretly urges other gods. The treaty makes the same demand about anyone, family included, who speaks against the king.

DEUT 13.6–11

DEUT 27.11–26

DEUT 28

DEUT 30.11–20

ESARHADDON SUCCESSION TREATY (672 BCE)

STEYMANS (1995)

JOB · ECCL (DISSENT)

TKC: DOM

DEUT 13.6–11

DEUT 27.11–26

DEUT 28

DEUT 30.11–20

ESARHADDON SUCCESSION TREATY (672 BCE)

STEYMANS (1995)

JOB · ECCL (DISSENT)

TKC: DOM

Enforcement, continued

WHAT IT DOES TO SUFFERING	If disaster is a penalty clause, every plague, defeat and famine becomes evidence of guilt. The prophets use this logic. Job and parts of Ecclesiastes refuse it. The Bible argues with itself here.
CHOOSE LIFE	Chapter 30 says the command "is not too hard for you, neither is it far off. It is not in heaven," and ends, "I have set before you life and death, blessing and curse. Therefore choose life." It adds a promise of return after exile, written by people who already knew exile.

CORRECTION TO THE OLD COMPANION The old companion said the curses run "more than four times as many" verses as the blessings. Fifty-four to fourteen is just under four times.

THE INSTRUMENT DOMINION INHERITS

POSSIBLE A liturgy in which the population says amen to its own punishment turns obedience into self-administration and any later misfortune into proof of an earlier offense. An empire holding this chapter never has to explain a famine. It only has to ask what the people did.

HOW MY WORLD EXPLAINS ITS LAST DISASTER, AND WHO WAS BLAMED FOR IT

One passage, worked properly

Choose one passage and run the method across this spread. If you want one chosen, try 17.14–20, the law of the king, or 15.1–11, the release.

PASSAGE

TRANSLATION USED

1 · WHAT IT SAYS. SUMMARIZE WITHOUT INTERPRETING. NO CONCLUSIONS YET

2 · WHO IS ADDRESSED, WHO IS DISCUSSED AND WHO IS ABSENT

3 · WHERE TWO TRANSLATIONS DIFFER, AND WHAT TURNS ON THE DIFFERENCE

METHOD

TKC: DOM

PART IX LOG

How it's been used

4 · HOW THIS PASSAGE HAS BEEN USED AGAINST SOMEONE, AND WHO BENEFITED

5 · WHAT IT COSTS THE PERSON IN POWER, IF IT'S ACTUALLY KEPT

6 · WHAT DOMINION WOULD DO WITH IT. CIRCULATE, RESTRICT OR SPIRITUALIZE

7 · WHAT I'M TAKING INTO THE MANUSCRIPT, AND WHICH CHAPTER

Anything found on these two pages begins as POSSIBLE. Move it to DECIDED only after deciding it belongs in the manuscript and logging where it affects the existing files.

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

The book that wrote the rest

Everything here is reception, what people did with Deuteronomy.

A SCROLL IN A WALL	A law book found during temple repairs, read to the king and answered with a national purge. Whatever the scroll was, the narrative makes a found document the trigger for a political revolution, the most useful plot mechanism in the Hebrew Bible.
THE HISTORY IT SHAPED	Martin Noth argued in 1943 that Joshua through Kings form a "Deuteronomistic History," grading every king by this book's standards, chapter 12 above all. What looks like national chronicle is closer to an audit against a statute.
IN THE GOSPELS	Jesus answers all three temptations with Deuteronomy (8.3, 6.16, 6.13) and names the Shema the first commandment. It's the book he quotes most in argument.
COVENANT AS POLITICS	John Winthrop closed "A Model of Christian Charity" (1630) by paraphrasing 30.15–20, "Therefore let us choose life," and Puritan covenant theology read New England through the book's terms. The conquest chapters were read as precedent by people arriving on other people's land.
AND THE OTHER WAY	Abolitionists cited 23.15–16 against the Fugitive Slave Act of 1850, and 24.7 with Exodus 21.16 against kidnapping and the slave trade. The same volume served the conqueror and the freed in the same century.

WHERE A FOUND DOCUMENT COULD OVERTURN SOMETHING IN MY MANUSCRIPT

2 KGS 22–23

JOSH–KGS (NOTH, 1943)

MATT 4.1–11

MARK 12.29

WINTHROP, "A MODEL OF CHRISTIAN CHARITY" (1630)

FUGITIVE SLAVE ACT (1850)

TKC: DOM

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHERE A FOUND DOCUMENT COULD OVERTURN SOMETHING IN MY MANUSCRIPT

The half the Empire teaches

DEUT 17.14–20

DEUT 15

DEUT 31.9–13

DEUT 28

TKC: DOM · SANCTUM

POSSIBLE Everything on this page is a TKC construction to test against the manuscript.

WHAT THE SANCTUM CIRCULATES	WHAT IT KEEPS IN THE CLOSED CATECHISM
ONE SANCTUARY, ONE CALENDAR, ONE AUTHORIZED PLACE OF OFFERING	The third-year tithe that stays in the town, and the tithe turned to coin and eaten by the household itself
THE CURSES OF CHAPTER 28, AS THE EXPLANATION FOR EVERY PLAGUE AND DEFEAT	The same covenant makes the sovereign subject to the document, with four named prohibitions
OBEDIENCE TAUGHT AS LOYALTY TO THE SANCTUM'S READING OF THE LAW	The law is read aloud to the whole assembly, women, children and foreigners included, on a fixed schedule
THE CONQUEST CHAPTERS, AS PRECEDENT FOR CLEANSING A PROVINCE	The runaway-slave clause, the seventh-year release and the ban on interest among kin
INSTRUCTION AS THE SANCTUM'S OFFICE, DELIVERED IN ITS BUILDINGS	Chapter 6 puts teaching in the house, in the parents' mouths, with no priest present

THE ARGUMENT IN ONE PARAGRAPH

INTERPRETATION Dominion keeps Deuteronomy's enforcement and drops its constitution. The curses, the central sanctuary and the war commands stay in general circulation. The law of the king, the release, the household school and the public reading go into the closed catechism. The Empire isn't opposed by a rival scripture. It's opposed by the second half of its own.

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHO IN MY CAST HAS READ CHAPTER 17, AND WHAT THEY DID THE DAY AFTER

What I take out of Deuteronomy

WRITING

DOSSIER CLOSE

QUEUE: D4

THE ONE THING THIS BOOK CHANGED ABOUT HOW I SEE DOMINION

WHAT I STILL DON'T UNDERSTAND. CARRY IT TO THE RESEARCH LIST.

A CLAUSE I'M TAKING STRAIGHT INTO THE MANUSCRIPT, AND WHERE

PROOFING GATE *log only, nothing is closed here*

Dossier IV has fifteen numbered pages, with content notes on pages 7, 8 and 10, and the conquest material carried as CONTESTED with no verdict printed. Outstanding for proofing: full citations with edition and year.

PROOFED BY | DATE | OUTSTANDING

NOTES

OPEN NOTES

ANYTHING THIS DOSSIER STARTED AND DIDN'T FINISH

I–IV

AFTER THE DOSSIERS

The Torah and TKC

Where the four books touch the world, by source, with every guess labeled

FIVE PAGES

TKC: TR · TL · CR · DR3 · AM · MEN

FR 0

FR 33

FR 35

FR 39

Genesis and Exodus in the world

THE PHASES	Phase One belongs to the Temple and is called Genesis, "Who are you?" Phase Two belongs to the Crown and is called Exodus, "How smart are you?" (TR). POSSIBLE The Crown's phase is named for the book about a ruler who loses an argument to two midwives and a labor force.
EDEN AND THE EVE PROBLEM	Eden is named for the garden (TL). The Broadcast's name for its narrative against a candidate whose intelligence becomes the story is the Eve problem, the woman "blamed for asking rather than thanked" (TR). INTERPRETATION Genesis 3 doesn't curse the woman or blame her for asking. The blame in the chapter comes from the man (3.12), and the Broadcast's narrative runs his defense.
GENESIS 3.16 IN THE ASSESSMENT	The Temple's marriage theology (CR) depends on reading 3.16 as prescription. POSSIBLE One of the three questions the Prelate writes for Eden personally (TR, name changed under FR 33) asks her to explain 3.16, and the grade depends on which reading she gives.
LEAH	Eden's younger sister Leah is a Commonwife under Temple review for not conceiving within the Covenant timeline (TL, MEN). In Genesis, Leah is the fertile wife, and the three barren matriarchs are the women the promise runs through. POSSIBLE The Temple's review quotes "be fruitful and multiply" and never mentions Sarah, Rebekah or Rachel.

Genesis and Exodus in the world, continued

REASSIGNMENT AND TAMAR	Miriam was reassigned to another man's household after Thomas left (**FR 0**). Thomas left voluntarily (**FR 3**). How reassignment works is deliberately open. **POSSIBLE** The Temple grounds it in levirate logic (Gen 38, Deut 25.5–10), which in scripture protects a widow's claim, and the Empire uses it to keep an abandoned wife inside the quota.
HAGAR AND NAMING	Hagar is the one person in scripture who names God. Celeste gave Eden a second name that's used only in the house (**TL**). **INTERPRETATION** Both are names the official record doesn't hold.
SUCCESSION	Crest's claim came through survivorship and not birth order, and Dorian is the rightful heir's son (**FR 35, 39**). Crest is Dorian's uncle (**FR 35**). **POSSIBLE** The Temple preaches Jacob over Esau and Judah over Reuben to make the 2061 succession sound like election.
SHIPHRAH AND PUAH	**POSSIBLE** The model for a Vowed officer who quietly doesn't comply. **INTERPRETATION** Eden's Public Testimony, where every sentence is defensible and the whole is incendiary (**TR**), is the midwives' answer to Pharaoh at book length.
EXODUS 20.12 IN THE ASSESSMENT	Draft Three turns "Honor thy father and thy mother" into a question about reporting an Unbound woman who housed her children without male authority (**DR3**). Celeste is that woman.

TKC: TR · TL · CR · DR3 · AM · MEN

FR 0

FR 33

FR 35

FR 39

TKC: TL · DOM · CR · DR3 · MEN

FR 32

FR 41–43

Leviticus and Deuteronomy in the World

JOSEPH'S ADMINISTRATION	**POSSIBLE** Imperial schoolbooks teach Joseph as the model administrator and the Fracture Years as Egypt's famine, with the Coalition as the steward who stored grain. The Restoration Act made rights conditional (**TL**), and Genesis 47 is the scriptural picture of a people trading freedom for food and thanking the crown.
THE CURSE OF HAM	Aurelia was built over Atlanta's Black memory (**DOM**). **OPEN QUESTION** Does the Temple teach the curse of Ham? If a character uses it, the narration has to know it's a documented misuse.
PASSOVER AND THE HOUSEHOLD	**INTERPRETATION** Celeste's kitchen table (**TL**), the Salt Ceremony and the old way of burial (**DOM**) are household religion of the kind Exodus 12 and Deuteronomy 6 describe, which is why the Temple can't license them.
SALT	Leviticus 2.13 requires "the salt of the covenant" on every grain offering. **POSSIBLE** The women's Salt Ceremony (**DOM**) uses the Temple's own covenant salt, and nobody in the Temple has noticed.

Leviticus and Deuteronomy in the world, continued

TKC: TL · DOM · CR · DR3 · MEN

FR 32

FR 41–43

INSPECTION	**POSSIBLE** The Vowed household assessments (**MEN**) and the Designation (**DOM**) borrow the Leviticus 13 procedure, with a moral weight Leviticus keeps out.
THE SCAPEGOAT	**POSSIBLE** The Broadcast's antagonist narrative, assigned to the candidate who threatens a comfortable outcome (**TR**), is the Empire's Azazel goat. The confession is spoken over her, and she's sent out.
LEVITICUS 25.10	**POSSIBLE** The Empire can't read the Liberty Bell verse aloud. In Pacific, where people remember trying to leave (**DOM**), somebody still can.
DEUTERONOMY 13	**POSSIBLE** The command to report a family member who secretly worships other gods is the Temple's warrant for the Vowed as surveillance (**CR**) and for the Assessment's reporting question (**DR3**).
GUILT BY HOUSEHOLD	"Children shall not be put to death for their fathers" (Deut 24.16). The Empire classifies children by household registration (**FR 32**). **INTERPRETATION** Deuteronomy, Ezekiel 18 and the Empire disagree about where guilt lives.
RUNAWAYS	**POSSIBLE** Ungoverned crossings through Sable (**DOM**) are the case Deuteronomy 23.15–16 was written for, and the Temple never reads it in that Dominion.
JOSIAH'S SCROLL AND THE LEDGER	Azrael found the ledger in the east wing archive, Dorian removed it with the Covenant of Dissent, and Judah has been looking for the Dissent since before his brother's exile (**TL**, **FR 41–43**). **POSSIBLE** Judah is a Josiah who hasn't found his scroll.

TKC: DOM · SANCTUM

FR 33

What it teaches and what it shelves

POSSIBLE The three "Dominion's" spreads from the dossiers, gathered in one place. Every row is a construction to test.

BOOK	WHAT THE TEMPLE CIRCULATES	WHAT IT LEAVES OUT OF PUBLIC TEACHING
EXODUS	The sea, as a deliverance already accomplished in the founding	Chapter 1, where the resistance starts with two midwives who lied to a king
EXODUS	The commandments from the second clause on	The preamble, which grounds the right to command in ending forced labor
EXODUS	Moses the obedient lawgiver	Moses arguing God out of a decision twice
LEVITICUS	Holiness as personal purity, chapters 18 and 20 as household law	Chapter 25 entire, and the harvest edge, the same-day wage and the interest ban
LEVITICUS	Restitution as an offering paid to the Temple	The wronged person is paid first, plus a fifth
DEUTERONOMY	The curses of chapter 28 as the explanation for every disaster	The law of the king
DEUTERONOMY	Teaching as the Temple's office	Chapter 6, where parents teach at home with no priest present
DEUTERONOMY	The conquest chapters as precedent	The runaway-slave clause and the seventh-year release

THE PATTERN

INTERPRETATION The pattern is the same in all three. The Empire keeps Deuteronomy's enforcement and drops its constitution, keeps Leviticus's machinery of exclusion and drops its machinery of release, and teaches the exodus as finished so only the obedience half applies now.

CORRECTION TO THE OLD COMPANION SUPERSEDED The old companion's Exodus page marked "Prelate Huldah's office" as canon. FR 33 renamed the Prelate. The working name is Prelate Aurelia, POSSIBLE, and whether the office manages the Temple's teaching of Exodus is only POSSIBLE now.

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

THE ROW I'D ADD, AND THE BOOK IT COMES FROM

Twelve working questions

Answer in any order. Each answer that settles something goes to the log with a number.

1 · WHAT DOES THE BOOK OF COVENANT PRINT AT GENESIS 3.16, AND WHAT DOES THE AURELIA TEMPLE PREACH FROM IT ON THE SUNDAY BEFORE A BINDING?

2 · WRITE THE ASSESSMENT QUESTION ON 3.16 THE PRELATE GIVES EDEN. WHAT ANSWER GETS FULL MARKS, AND WHAT DOES EDEN SAY?

3 · WHO NAMED THE DOMINIONS, AND DID THEY KNOW WHAT GENESIS 1.28 SAYS?

4 · WHICH OF GENESIS'S SIX WOMEN DOES CELESTE TEACH EDEN ABOUT AT THE KITCHEN TABLE, AND WHICH DOES THE TEMPLE TEACH GIRLS AT DESIGNATION AGE?

5 · WHAT DOES LEAH OSEI KNOW ABOUT THE GENESIS LEAH, AND WHO TOLD HER?

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

6 · HOW DOES THE TEMPLE EXPLAIN COMMONWIFE REASSIGNMENT FROM SCRIPTURE, IF IT DOES? WHO SIGNED MIRIAM'S?

Twelve working questions, continued

7 · WHICH LICENSED PROFESSIONAL IN THE EMPIRE IS A SHIPHRAH, AND WHAT DOES SHE SAY WHEN SHE'S SUMMONED?

8 · WHAT DOES THE EMPIRE'S LIBERATION LITURGY SAY GOD DELIVERED THE PEOPLE FROM, AND WHEN DOES A CHARACTER STOP BELIEVING IT?

9 · WHICH HOUSEHOLD IN THE CAST WOULD A JUBILEE FREE, AND WHO WOULD LOSE BY IT?

10 · WHAT DISQUALIFIES A BODY FROM SERVICE IN THE EMPIRE? WHO WROTE THE LIST, AND DOES IT CITE LEVITICUS 21?

11 · WHO IN THE CAST HAS READ DEUTERONOMY 17 ALL THE WAY THROUGH, AND WHAT DID THEY DO THE NEXT DAY?

12 · IF THE COVENANT OF DISSENT TURNED UP IN THE REGISTRY TOMORROW, WHO WOULD BE ASKED TO AUTHENTICATE IT, THE WAY HULDAH AUTHENTICATED JOSIAH'S SCROLL?